30 April 2026

Insurance Handbook

Employer Sponsored and Personal

The information in this document forms part of the **Aware Super Future Saver Product Disclosure Statement** (PDS) for employer sponsored and personal members, dated 30 April 2026.

This Insurance Handbook may not apply to all employers. Please visit **aware.com.au/pds** to access the Insurance Handbook relevant to you.



Prepared and issued by Aware Super Pty Ltd ABN 11 118 202 672, AFSL 293340 as trustee of Aware Super ABN 53 226 460 365

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This Insurance Handbook (Handbook) has been prepared by Aware Super Pty Ltd (referred to in this document as the 'trustee', 'we', 'us' or 'our'), the trustee of Aware Super (referred to in this document as 'Aware Super' or 'the fund'). The Fund is governed by a trust deed ('Trust Deed') as amended from time to time. For a copy of the Trust Deed see **aware.com.au/policies** or alternatively, you can contact the Member Support Team on **1300 650 873**. **If there is an inconsistency between the information in this document and the terms of the Trust Deed, the Trust Deed will prevail. This document contains general information only. It does not take into account your specific objectives, financial situation or needs. You should consider the information having regard to your personal circumstances before making a decision.** It is recommended that you consult a financial adviser if you require financial advice that takes into account your personal circumstances.

The information contained in this Handbook was accurate at the time of its preparation. However, some of the information can change from time to time and the trustee can change matters which are the subject of representations made in the Product Disclosure Statement (PDS) and this Handbook. If the change is not materially adverse, the updated information will be available on our website at **aware.com.au/pdsupdates**. A paper copy of this Handbook and any update will be available free of charge by contacting us on **1300 650 873**.

We may change any matter in the PDS and this Handbook without member consent, but in the case of an increase in fees and charges we will notify members at least 30 days before the change occurs. This offer is only made to persons receiving this Handbook and the applicable PDS (electronically or otherwise) in Australia.

Insurance described in this Insurance Handbook is provided under group life insurance and group income protection policies issued by TAL Life Limited, ABN 70 050 109 450, AFSL 237848 ('the insurer' or 'TAL'). This Insurance Handbook is intended to be a guide to the insurance available through us under the policies, however, all insurance is subject to the precise terms of those policies which will prevail to the extent of any inconsistency. Examples provided are for illustration purposes only. Your personal circumstances are likely to be different and may be more complex than the examples used.



Super healthy benefits

Living well isn't just about finances – it's also about staying healthy, active, and mentally strong. Which is why having insurance through Aware Super gives you access to a range of health and wellbeing programs. They are completely confidential and included at no extra cost.

Your access is extended to your partner and children over 18. You do not require a doctor referral, and in some cases, you can use these services even if you don't have insurance with us.

- **Nutrition and fitness** consult with a dietitian or exercise physiologist and get a personalised plan.
- **Mental health assist** speak with mental health clinicians and get a diagnosis and treatment recommendations.
- **Menopause support** speak with a women's health nurse for help navigating symptoms.
- **Grief Counselling** speak to a grief support counsellor to get support in times of grief.
- **Online directory and tools** to help locate free or low-cost health support and get personalised resources.

Find out more at **aware.com.au/health**

About us

As one of Australia's largest profit-for-members superannuation funds, we always remember whose money it is and whose future we're looking after. Super returns, expert super advice and guidance are what make us super helpful.

Our insurer is TAL

As a superannuation fund we must seek insurance for our members from a life insurance company. We use our size to look for the best suitable insurance arrangements. We've chosen TAL Life Limited as providing the best value, and we'll regularly review our insurance arrangements to make sure members get the best value possible.

All references to the 'insurer' in this *Insurance Handbook* mean TAL Life Limited ABN 70 050 109 450, AFSL 237848.

The trustee has two group insurance policies with TAL – one for death and total and permanent disablement (TPD) cover and one for income protection (IP) cover. Where you see references to 'the policy' or 'the policies', we're referring to these insurance policies.

If you have insurance, the premiums we deduct from your Future Saver account go to TAL to pay for your insurance. If you or your beneficiaries make a successful claim, TAL pays your death, terminal illness or TPD insurance benefit to us for deposit into your Future Saver account (note that IP benefits are paid directly by TAL to you). Any insurance amount can only be paid to you by the trustee when a condition of release (a legislative requirement) is met.

This *Insurance Handbook* is a summary of the current insurance arrangements we have with TAL on behalf of Aware Super members. If there is any inconsistency between this *Insurance Handbook* and the terms in the policies, the terms in the policies prevail.

Using this *Insurance Handbook*

Throughout this *Insurance Handbook* we use icons to draw your attention to certain things:

This icon...	means...
$	this could impact the cost of your insurance
⏰	this is something you need to do within a certain time period (e.g. within 2 months)

About some of the words and terms we use

Throughout this *Insurance Handbook*, some words and terms are underlined as they each have a particular meaning in the policies. These definitions are explained in the 'What the words mean' section.

Please make sure you read these definitions so you understand what the terms mean. If you'd like a copy of the policies, please contact us.



Why have insurance through your super account?

Insurance is about protecting yourself and your family financially if something happens and you can't work. If you have insurance and need to make a claim due to illness or injury, any insurance benefits you receive could help you and your family cover some of life's major expenses. The money could also be used to help your family members meet their financial commitments if you die.

Insurance through your super account is convenient and affordable. The cost is paid from your super account rather than being paid as an out-of-pocket expense. And you may be entitled to automatic insurance without needing to answer any medical or personal questions.

Other advantages are:

- premiums are generally lower than if you were to take out an individual policy – our fund represents over 560,000 insured members and means we can negotiate better value for money for your insurance
- we pass a tax deduction on to you for insurance premiums paid by you.

We're here to help when you need to make a claim

We act in our members' best financial interests at all times and are always available to help you with your super and insurance in the fund. If you need to make a claim, your personal claims manager can help you complete all the paperwork and will guide you every step of the way.

Insurance through your Future Saver account

Each of us has different needs. When thinking about life insurance, it's a good idea to look at your situation and think about which types of insurance are right for you, and how much you need. Our insurance is flexible, so you can apply for the available types and amounts of insurance you want at any time.

Three types of cover

You can choose from three types of insurance. They're designed to protect you and your family if you become disabled and can't work, or to help your family if you die.

This type of cover...	does this...
Death (includes terminal illness) cover	pays a benefit to you if you're diagnosed with a terminal illness, or to your beneficiaries if you die.
Total and permanent disablement (TPD) cover	pays a benefit to you if you become totally and permanently disabled by Illness or Injury and can never work again.
Income protection (IP) cover	pays a monthly benefit to you if you suffer a loss of income and can't work because you're totally disabled or partially disabled by Illness or Injury. A monthly payment can help you focus on your recovery and return to work without draining your savings.

Eligibility criteria apply for all claims. Insurance will become payable if the insurer accepts your claim. Payment of an approved IP claim will be made by the insurer directly to you. Payment of an approved death, terminal illness or TPD claim will be made by the insurer to us for deposit into your Future Saver account. Any insurance amount can only be paid to you or your beneficiaries by the trustee when a condition of release (a legislative requirement) is met.

You can apply for any of these types of cover at any time. However, your TPD cover amount can never be more than your death cover amount.

You can apply to increase or decrease or cancel your cover at any time, subject to the terms of the policies.

Please note: It's important to understand your insurance premium deductions may erode your account balance. You should consider if your cover through Aware Super is appropriate for your financial circumstances and whether or not you would like to maintain or amend your insurance.

Under superannuation law, we're not able to provide insurance until you're at least age 25 and your account balance has reached $6,000. We also aren't able to provide insurance if your account becomes inactive for a continuous period of 16 months.

The above won't apply if you inform us through an application for insurance that you'd like to have cover regardless of your age and/or your account balance or if your employer has been identified by us as qualifying for the dangerous occupation exception.

For more information on inactive accounts see page 12. For more information on the dangerous occupation exception see page 9.

Death and TPD cover

There are two options for death and TPD cover – **age-based cover** and **fixed cover**. Under both options you can apply for cover from age 15 and cover ends at age 70. The premium per $1,000 of cover is also the same under both options.

Age-based cover	Fixed cover
With **age-based cover**, your amount of cover increases each year until age 35. It stays the same until it starts decreasing from age 41 onwards. The age-based cover scale is shown on the next page. You can choose any multiple of the age-based cover scale in multiples of 0.5 (that is, 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0 and so on, up to the maximum amounts allowed under the policy).	If you want your cover amount to stay the same as you get older, you can choose **fixed cover**. With fixed cover, the amount of cover stays the same until it ends when you reach age 70. The only exception is that fixed TPD cover starts to taper (reduce) from age 61, in equal amounts down to zero at age 70 (see more details below).

Basic Cover and Basic Plus Cover

Basic Cover gives you death and TPD cover equal to the age-based cover scale. If you are eligible, you can apply for this cover at any time, or you may get it automatically.

Basic Plus Cover gives you death and TPD cover equal to **double** the Basic Cover amount. If you are eligible, you can apply for Basic Plus Cover at any time. When you apply for Basic Plus Cover, your application can also include IP cover. IP cover taken up as part of Basic Plus Cover is available with a 60 or 90-day waiting period and a 2 year or 5-year benefit period.

When you get Basic Cover automatically

If you join the fund through an application made by your employer, you will get Basic Cover automatically, if you become eligible. For more information see 'When your insurance starts and ends' on page 8.

IP cover is not provided automatically, you must apply for it if you want it (see 'Applying for IP cover' on page 27).

Depending on your employer, different insurance arrangements may apply. These arrangements may impact the type and amount of cover available to you and the premiums payable. For more information about the insurance arrangements that may apply to you, refer to the relevant *Insurance Handbook* available at **aware.com.au/pds**.

Basic Cover is not compulsory. You can opt out of automatic Basic Cover before it starts by logging into Member Online or by completing the *(V515) Opt out of automatic insurance* form, available on our website. You can also reduce or cancel your cover by logging into Member Online.

When you can apply for Basic Cover and Basic Plus Cover

You can apply for Basic Cover and Basic Plus Cover at any time, subject to meeting eligibility and other criteria. You can apply for Basic Plus Cover even if you do not have Basic Cover. When applying for cover, you will be asked several questions including about your employment, health and lifestyle.

If you join the fund via our online portal, or by completing an application form (that is, you do not join through an employer), you won't receive Basic Cover automatically. But you can apply for it (and Basic Plus Cover) online at any time by answering several questions, including about your employment, health and lifestyle. For more information see 'When your insurance starts and ends' on page 8.

Full premium refund if you cancel automatic Basic Cover within 60 days

We'll let you know if your Basic Cover starts automatically. If you tell us to cancel it within 60 days of the date it's activated, we'll cancel the cover from the day it started (meaning that your cover will be treated as if it never existed) and refund any premiums you've paid. This only applies to Basic Cover you receive automatically.

The letter you receive will let you know the date by which you'll need to cancel your Basic Cover to get a full refund of the premiums.

Your TPD cover automatically reduces from age 61

If you have fixed TPD cover before age 61, it will reduce in equal amounts each year from age 61 until it expires at age 70. If you take up fixed TPD cover after your 61st birthday, it will reduce in equal amounts each year from your next birthday until it expires at age 70.

Example

Fixed TPD cover reducing

John takes up $100,000 of death and TPD fixed cover when he is aged 50. When he reaches age 61, his death cover stays at $100,000 but his TPD cover reduces to $90,000. His TPD cover will continue to reduce by $10,000 every year on his birthday until it ends when he turns 70.

If John had instead taken up $100,000 of death and TPD fixed cover at age 65, his death cover would stay at $100,000 but his TPD cover would reduce by the same amount each year on his birthday until it ends at age 70. In John's situation, his TPD cover will reduce by $20,000 each year, starting on his 66th birthday.

The following table shows:

- the amount of death and TPD cover provided at each age under the age-based cover scale (which is the level of cover provided under Basic Cover); and
- the cost (before the tax deduction benefit) of Basic Cover at each age, which depends on your insurance category.

If you get Basic Cover automatically and you don't already have an insurance category assigned to you, you'll get the same insurance category as the one that has been assigned to your employer.
If your job is different from other workers in the organisation where you work (e.g. you work in the head office of a mining company and don't use heavy machinery), the insurance category assigned to you based on your employer may not align to your occupation. **In these situations, you should apply for a review of your insurance category.** See pages 14-16 for more information about insurance categories.

Basic Cover (age-based cover)

Age last birthday	Cover	Annual premium by insurance category (death and TPD cover)			
		Professional	Low Risk	Medium Risk	High Risk
15	$27,000	$2.54	$3.24	$5.40	$6.51
16	$40,500	$4.94	$6.38	$10.63	$13.28
17	$59,700	$9.31	$12.09	$20.15	$25.61
18	$78,900	$14.04	$18.34	$30.57	$39.61
19	$87,900	$18.11	$23.73	$39.56	$51.77
20	$97,500	$21.65	$28.52	$47.53	$63.18
21	$108,300	$25.02	$33.30	$55.50	$75.97
22	$120,000	$28.32	$37.80	$63.00	$86.88
23	$132,900	$32.69	$43.86	$73.10	$102.20
24	$147,000	$37.63	$50.72	$84.53	$119.66
25	$164,700	$43.81	$59.29	$98.82	$141.48
26	$177,900	$49.10	$66.71	$111.19	$160.82
27	$191,100	$54.65	$74.53	$124.22	$181.35
28	$203,100	$59.10	$80.73	$134.55	$197.31
29	$215,100	$65.82	$90.34	$150.57	$223.49
30	$224,100	$70.82	$97.48	$162.47	$242.92
31	$232,800	$77.06	$106.51	$177.51	$268.07
32	$240,900	$82.15	$113.83	$189.71	$288.24
33	$249,000	$88.64	$123.26	$205.43	$314.74
34	$255,000	$95.88	$133.88	$223.13	$345.27
35	$261,000	$104.92	$146.81	$244.69	$380.54
36	$261,000	$118.49	$166.39	$277.31	$434.83
37	$261,000	$129.46	$182.05	$303.41	$477.37
38	$261,000	$143.29	$201.62	$336.04	$529.44
39	$261,000	$158.17	$223.16	$371.93	$589.60
40	$261,000	$173.04	$244.69	$407.81	$649.76
41	$249,000	$182.02	$257.72	$429.53	$686.37
42	$237,000	$191.97	$271.96	$453.26	$725.22
43	$225,000	$199.80	$283.50	$472.50	$758.70
44	$207,900	$203.33	$288.46	$480.77	$771.72
45	$191,100	$205.05	$290.95	$484.92	$778.64
46	$167,200	$197.80	$280.90	$468.16	$753.15
47	$143,400	$184.70	$262.42	$437.37	$704.38
48	$124,100	$176.84	$251.30	$418.84	$674.79
49	$108,300	$167.97	$238.80	$398.00	$641.84
50	$93,600	$159.49	$226.75	$377.91	$609.43
51	$78,300	$152.69	$217.28	$362.14	$585.29
52	$63,300	$140.97	$200.82	$334.70	$542.20
53	$54,000	$138.08	$196.83	$328.05	$532.20
54	$45,000	$131.76	$187.99	$313.31	$509.27
55	$36,200	$121.92	$174.03	$290.05	$471.94
56	$31,800	$122.72	$175.30	$292.16	$476.16
57	$27,400	$121.03	$173.03	$288.39	$470.88
58	$24,500	$124.22	$177.69	$296.14	$484.12
59	$19,000	$110.39	$158.03	$263.39	$431.30
60	$16,300	$108.64	$155.62	$259.37	$425.31
61	$13,800	$105.34	$151.01	$251.68	$413.37
62	$12,600	$110.41	$158.38	$263.97	$434.13
63	$12,000	$120.50	$172.98	$288.30	$474.88
64	$10,800	$124.24	$178.44	$297.41	$490.44
65	$10,000	$118.22	$169.20	$282.00	$461.53
66	$10,000	$121.16	$172.88	$288.13	$468.39
67	$10,000	$124.28	$176.78	$294.63	$475.67
68	$10,000	$127.76	$181.13	$301.88	$483.79
69	$10,000	$131.60	$185.93	$309.88	$492.75

Income protection cover

Income protection (IP) cover is optional and can only be **fixed** cover. When you apply for IP cover, you will be asked to nominate the amount of cover you want, subject to the maximum limits under the policy. This amount (if accepted by the insurer) won't automatically change as you get older or as your salary changes, and will end when you reach age 65. See page 27 for full details of IP cover.

Choosing the right insurance

The right insurance for you depends on your personal situation. You can talk with one of our advisers (fees may apply, for more information on our advice options go to **aware.com.au/adviceoptions**) about which types of insurance would be best for your situation and how much you need. Some things to consider include:

- how many people depend on your income (such as children, partners and relatives)
- if you have a home loan or other large debts to pay off
- whether you have sufficient savings to support a long period of time off work due to illness or injury, or to leave to your family if you die
- if your work, lifestyle or hobbies could lead to an illness or injury.

One way to decide is to think about all the costs your family currently has to pay. If you died or could never work again, it would be reassuring to know that your insurance could help pay these costs.

If...	this cover might suit you...	because...
you're single and have no major debts	Basic Cover and income protection	you might have minimal financial commitments that need to be met if you become unwell or die.
you and your partner have bought a property or had a child	Basic Plus Cover and income protection	it gives you twice as much death and TPD cover as Basic Cover, and others may depend on your income.
you have large debts and a lot of dependants	a combination of cover types and amounts of your choosing	you might need more than Basic Plus Cover offers for your age.

With our flexible options, you can apply for the available types and amounts of cover you want at any time. The insurance calculator on our website can help you work out how much insurance you may need and how much it could cost. Go to **aware.com.au/insurancecalculator**. Applications are subject to acceptance by the insurer.

Ask one of our advisers

We deduct insurance premiums from your Future Saver account each month. These deductions reduce your super and mean you'll have less retirement savings to live on when you retire. However, if you become ill or injured and qualify for an insurance benefit, you'll be pleased that you had insurance.

You should think carefully about the insurance that best suits your needs. You can speak with one of our Super Advisers, at no extra cost, about how much insurance you need and the costs, so you can decide what works best for you.

Go to **aware.com.au/book** to find out more and book an appointment.

Excluded occupations

Normally you can apply for insurance through your Future Saver account, regardless of your occupation. The insurer will assess your application and may accept your application without restrictions, or apply exclusions or premium loadings. They may decline your application based on your health, lifestyle or responses to other questions.

However, if you're a sworn NSW Police Officer or Student Police Officer, you need to refer to the *Insurance Handbook – NSW Police Officers* for information about the insurance options applicable to you.

Employer sponsored members who are NSW Ambulance Officers, sworn NSW Police Officers or Student Police Officers should refer to the relevant *Insurance Handbook* for *Future Saver – Ambulance Officers* or *Future Saver – NSW Police Officers*.

If you have more than one Future Saver account

If you have insurance through two or more Future Saver accounts, the insurer will generally only pay death (including terminal illness) or TPD insurance benefits for one of those accounts – the one paying the largest benefit. Where the amounts are the same, the insurer will generally pay the amount that commenced first. The other insurance would be cancelled and any premiums paid for that insurance would be refunded.

When your insurance starts and ends

When your insurance starts depends on if you join the fund through an application made by your employer, or if you join personally via our online portal or by completing an application form.

If...	then...
you join the fund through an application made by your employer	you automatically receive Basic Cover if you become eligible. You can also apply for insurance at any time, if certain criteria are met.
you join the fund personally via our online portal or by completing an application form	you do not get Basic Cover automatically; however you can apply for insurance at any time, if certain criteria are met.

If you join the fund through an employer

If you join the fund through an application made by your employer, you'll get Basic Cover automatically, subject to the eligibility terms below.

Eligibility for Basic Cover automatically

Unless your employer qualifies for a 'Dangerous Occupation Exception' (see page 9), you must reach your eligibility date before you can be eligible for Basic Cover automatically.

Your eligibility date is the first day on which both of the following apply:

- you have a Future Saver account balance of at least $6,000; and
- you're at least 25 years old but under age 70.

You become eligible for Basic Cover automatically when we receive a Superannuation Guarantee (SG) contribution into your Future Saver account on or after your eligibility date and before you reach age 70, provided that:

- you don't already hold, and have not previously held, Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover or automatic death and TPD cover under previous insurance arrangements in the fund or other superannuation funds that have merged into the fund, including any such cover that has been altered, reduced or converted to fixed cover; and
- you've not cancelled or opted out of Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover or automatic death and TPD cover under previous insurance arrangements in the fund or other superannuation funds that have merged into the fund.

You can apply to receive Basic Cover at any time before you become eligible to get it automatically, if certain criteria are met. For example, if you're under age 25 or have a Future Saver account balance of less than $6,000, you may be able to activate your Basic Cover early, by applying online and answering questions about your employment, health and lifestyle, provided you haven't previously held, or opted out of, Basic Cover.

When your Basic Cover starts automatically

Provided you are eligible, your automatic Basic Cover will commence as follows:

- If your employer pays a SG contribution into your Future Saver account on, or by no later than 6 months after, your eligibility date, your Basic Cover starts on your eligibility date, provided that the SG contribution is received by us before you reach age 70.
- If your employer pays a SG contribution into your Future Saver account **more than 6 months** after your eligibility date, your Basic Cover starts on the date we get that contribution, provided that the SG contribution is received by us before you reach age 70.
- If your employer never pays a SG contribution into your Future Saver account on or after your eligibility date, your Basic Cover will never start automatically.

Example

Basic Cover starts on eligibility date

- Amy joined the fund via her employer, is aged 35 and has $5,000 in her Future Saver account, so she does not have enough money in her account to be eligible for Basic Cover automatically
- Her employer is paying SG contributions into her Future Saver account
- Her account reaches $6,000 on 17 May 2023 (her eligibility date)
- The first SG contribution after her eligibility date is received by us on 27 July 2023, which is less than 6 months after her eligibility date

Eligibility date	17 May 2023
Date of first SG contribution on or after eligibility date	27 July 2023
Basic Cover starts	17 May 2023

Example

Basic Cover starts when SG contribution is received

- Mitchell joined the fund via his employer, is aged 24 and has $10,000 in his Future Saver account, so he is too young to be eligible for Basic Cover automatically.
- He turns 25 on 7 June 2023, and he already has more than $6,000 in his account, so that date is his eligibility date.
- His employer is paying SG contributions into his Future Saver account, but as he has been on unpaid leave, the first SG contribution after his eligibility date is not received by us until 20 December 2023, which is more than 6 months after his eligibility date.

Eligibility date	7 June 2023
Date of first SG contribution on or after eligibility date	20 December 2023
Basic Cover starts	20 December 2023

Dangerous occupation exception (DOE)

Some occupations are considered dangerous and people in these occupations can find it more difficult to get insurance. We can apply an exception for these occupations which means these people are eligible to get Basic Cover automatically, even if they're under age 25 or have less than $6,000 in their account.

If your employer has been identified by us as qualifying for the dangerous occupation exception ('DOE employer') you may be eligible for Basic Cover as soon as your DOE employer pays a SG contribution into your Future Saver account, provided that:

- you don't already hold, and have not previously held, Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover or automatic death and TPD cover under previous insurance arrangements in the fund or other superannuation funds that have merged into the fund, including any such cover that has been altered, reduced or converted to fixed cover; and
- you've not cancelled or opted out of Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover or automatic death and TPD cover under previous insurance arrangements in the fund or other superannuation funds that have merged into the fund.

If this applies to you, we will write to you within 28 days of applying this exception to your account to let you know.

When your Basic Cover starts under the DOE arrangements

- If your DOE employer pays a SG contribution (before your turn 70) into your Future Saver account on, or by no later than 6 months after, your Employment Commencement Date with that employer, your Basic Cover starts on your Employment Commencement Date.
- If you join the fund directly as a personal member and you later start working for a DOE employer, you may become eligible for automatic Basic Cover. Your Basic Cover starts on the date we are notified of your employment with your DOE employer, so long as your DOE employer pays a SG contribution (before you turn 70) into your Future Saver account on, or by no later than 6 months after, your Employment Commencement Date with your DOE employer.
- If your DOE employer pays a SG contribution (before you turn 70) into your Future Saver account **more than 6 months** after your Employment Commencement Date with that employer, your Basic Cover starts on the date we get that contribution.
- If your DOE employer never pays a SG contribution into your Future Saver account, your Basic Cover never starts automatically under the dangerous occupation exception arrangements.

If DOE arrangements apply to you, we'll advise you within 28 days of us being notified by your employer.

Limited Cover Conditions

When you receive Basic Cover automatically, your cover is subject to Limited Cover Conditions in some situations. In other words, this means the insurer won't pay any claims for an Illness or Injury that occurred, or was apparent, before the date your cover started.

Your Basic Cover (when provided automatically) is subject to Limited Cover Conditions, as follows:

If...	Limited Cover Conditions apply...
we get the first SG contribution for you on, or by no later than 6 months after, your eligibility date (or on, or by no later than 6 months after, your Employment Commencement Date when the dangerous occupation exception provision applies)	until the day you are first at work on or after the day that your cover starts.
we get the first SG contribution for you **more than 6 months after** your eligibility date (or **more than 6 months after** your Employment Commencement Date when the dangerous occupation exception provision applies)	for the first 12 months after cover starts; and thereafter until the day you are first at work after the first 12 months period ends.
you've previously been paid a TPD or terminal illness insurance benefit from the fund, any other super fund or any insurance policy	for TPD and terminal illness cover for the duration of your cover with the fund.

You can apply for more cover

Aware Super offers eligible members the opportunity to add or increase their cover in the fund up to maximum limits, including:

- You can apply to have, or increase, age-based death only or death and TPD cover at any time, as long as the amount you choose is a multiple of the age-based cover scale equal to 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, 2.5 and so on, within the policy's Maximum Cover Limits and subject to the insurer's acceptance.
- Basic Plus Cover – after receiving Basic Cover, you may wish to increase your Basic Cover by applying for Basic Plus Cover. Basic Plus Cover gives you twice as much death and TPD cover as Basic Cover. When you apply for Basic Plus Cover, your application can also include optional IP cover. If IP cover is taken up as part of Basic Plus Cover, you can choose either a 60 or 90 day waiting period and a 2 or 5 year benefit period. You cannot apply for Basic Plus Cover if you have already reduced or cancelled your Basic Cover, or have converted your Basic Cover to fixed cover, or have opted out of Basic Cover.
- If you already have Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover, you can apply to convert it to fixed cover at any time. We'll change all your existing cover to fixed cover. Your death cover amount will stay the same regardless of your age until it expires at age 70. Your TPD cover will remain the same until it starts tapering (reducing) in equal amounts from your 61st birthday (see 'Your TPD cover automatically reduces from age 61' on page 5). The cost of fixed cover increases with your age.
- If you already have fixed death only or death and TPD cover, you can apply to convert it to age-based cover at any time. We'll change all your existing cover to age-based cover. Your death and TPD cover amounts change with your age and will automatically start decreasing from age 41 until it expires at age 70. The cost of age-based cover will change with your age.
- Additional fixed cover – you can apply for additional fixed death only, death and TPD, or IP cover (in addition to any automatic Basic Cover, or Basic Plus Cover, or fixed cover that you may already have), which means the amount of cover is fixed regardless of your age. The only exception is that fixed TPD cover starts to taper (reduce) from age 61, in equal amounts down to zero at age 70 (see 'Your TPD cover automatically reduces from age 61' on page 5). The cost of fixed cover increases with your age.
- The option of applying to transfer cover from another life insurance policy or through another super fund to Aware Super.
- The option of applying for additional cover as a result of Life Events.

When applying for cover, you will be asked questions including about your employment, health and lifestyle and other information to allow the insurer to assess your application.

Your application will be subject to eligibility requirements and a health assessment, insurance policy conditions, and acceptance by the insurer, and you may not be approved for cover. While your application is being considered, you will be eligible for interim accident cover (see page 33).

The cost of Basic Plus Cover and fixed cover is the same as the age-based cost per $1,000 of Basic Cover.

Increasing your automatic Basic Cover to Basic Plus Cover

After receiving Basic Cover automatically, you may wish to increase your cover by applying for Basic Plus Cover. You can do this at any time. When applying for Basic Plus Cover, you will be asked questions about your employment, health and lifestyle. The easiest way to do this is by logging into Member Online.

If you join the fund directly (not through your employer)

If you join the fund personally via our online portal or by completing an application form, you don't get Basic Cover automatically.

Instead, you can apply for any type of cover at any time. This includes Basic Cover and Basic Plus Cover. The easiest way to apply for cover is by logging into Member Online.

Applying for Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover

If you apply for cover **within 6 months** after opening your Future Saver account, you can get Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover by satisfactorily answering several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle.

If you apply for Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover **6 or more months after** opening your Future Saver account, the insurer will ask you a more detailed set of questions.

The insurer will review your answers and decide whether or not to offer you cover. If you apply for Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover online, you'll get this decision immediately.

You can only get Basic Cover once in your account's lifetime (either automatically or by applying). If you cancel Basic Cover you cannot obtain it again either automatically or by applying for it.

How to apply

To apply for additional cover, the simplest way is by logging into Member Online and clicking on the 'insurance' tab. If you don't have online access, call us on **1300 650 873**.

When providing information for your application for insurance cover, you owe the insurer a duty to take reasonable care not to make a misrepresentation (see 'Your duty to take reasonable care' on page 37). When you apply for additional cover, your application will be subject to eligibility requirements and you will need to provide information including about your health, occupation, income and lifestyle. The insurer may, at its discretion, accept your application (with or without conditions) or decline it.

When your insurance starts

If the insurer agrees to give you insurance, it starts on the date they approve your application. We'll confirm this date to you in writing. The insurance category you have been approved for will apply to all previous insurance you have in place at the time of your application.

If you later join a participating employer

If you join the fund directly, and you later start working for an employer who is registered with us (participating employer), any existing insurance you have already obtained will remain unaffected. Whether or not you have existing insurance, you may later also get Basic Cover automatically, as if you had joined the fund through your employer (this is subject to eligibility conditions – see 'If you join the fund through an employer' on page 8, noting that Basic Cover (if obtained in these circumstances) would never start any earlier than your eligibility date).

Before you apply

Before you apply for cover, you must have money in your Future Saver account to pay for the cost of cover.

The only exception is if you want to transfer cover in from another fund or insurance policy. You can apply to do this as soon as you join the fund, even if you have no money in your Future Saver account at that time, but you need to have money in your account by the time we deduct the first premium (see 'Transferring in other cover' on page 35).

When your insurance ends

Your cover ends on the earliest date on which any of these things happen:

- you stop being a member of the fund (*all cover types*)
- you reach the benefit ceasing age (*70 for death and TPD cover, 65 for income protection cover*)
- you die (*all cover types*)
- you are entitled to receive a terminal illness benefit (if your death cover is higher than your terminal illness benefit, your death cover will continue at a lower amount) (*terminal illness cover*)
- you are entitled to receive a TPD benefit (if your death cover is higher than your TPD benefit, your death cover will continue at a lower amount) (*TPD cover only*)
- we get your request to cancel your cover by phone, online or in writing (*all cover types*)
- the last day of the calendar month in which there's not enough money in your Future Saver account to pay for your cover (*all cover types*)
- the date on which your Future Saver account has been inactive (received no contribution or rollover) for 16 continuous months, unless you have asked us to keep your cover going before it ends (see next page) (*all cover types*)
- the date our policy with the insurer ends (we'll tell you in advance if this is going to happen) (*all cover types*).

See 'If your account becomes inactive' below for how you can re-apply for cover which has ceased because there is insufficient money in your account, or how to keep your cover before your account becomes inactive for a continuous period of 16 months or more.

Stopping your IP cover when a TPD claim is approved

If the insurer approves your TPD claim and you also have IP cover, we will cease your IP cover (and IP premiums) effective from the day that the insurer approves your TPD claim. You will continue to be able to make an IP claim if you have a date of disablement for IP purposes prior to this date.

If you are already receiving IP benefits on the date that we cease your IP cover, you will continue to be entitled to receive those payments until you cease to qualify for them (e.g. you reach the end of the IP benefit period).

If your account becomes inactive

Your Future Saver account becomes inactive when it stops receiving any contributions or rollovers into it. Whilst this can be quite normal, particularly if you have career breaks, it does have an implication for your insurance if it lasts for a continuous period of 16 months, as explained below.

If we don't get a contribution or rollover into your Future Saver account for a continuous period of 16 months since the date of the last contribution or rollover, the law requires us to cancel your insurance unless, before that time, you ask us to keep it.

We'll write to you after 9, 12 and 15 months of inactivity to remind you that your insurance is going to end after 16 months. You can reactivate your account by making a contribution or by asking us to keep your insurance going. Alternatively, you can ask us to cancel your insurance.

If your insurance is cancelled because your account has become inactive for 16 continuous months, it cannot be reinstated. If you want cover at a later date, you will need to apply.

How to reactivate your account before cover is cancelled

If your account has become inactive, you can reactivate it before the end of the 16th month by:

- making a contribution into your Future Saver account; or
- having your employer make a contribution into your Future Saver account, or
- transferring (rolling over) super you have with another fund into your Future Saver account.

Any of these will reactivate your account for the next 16 months, so your insurance won't be cancelled during that period (unless it ends for a reason described in When your insurance ends on the previous page).

You can ask us to keep your insurance going even if your account later becomes inactive

You can complete a *Make an insurance election* online, before the end of the 16th month to ask us to keep your insurance going, even though your Future Saver account may become inactive in the future. If you make this election, your insurance will continue and we'll deduct the premiums from your Future Saver account, which means your account balance may reduce over time.

To ensure cover does not cease, your account balance must be sufficient to meet insurance fees, including premiums. Insurance may end for other reasons described in the 'When your insurance ends' section on page 11.

How to cancel your insurance

You can cancel some or all of your insurance at any time by logging into Member Online and requesting the change. However, if later you want cover, you will have to apply, and need to provide information, or to complete a full personal statement. If you don't have online access, call us on **1300 650 873**.

Overseas

You're able to travel overseas without your insurance cover being affected. As long as you have an adequate balance to cover premiums, your cover will continue to remain active, subject to you meeting all other eligibility criteria to retain cover and as long as your account is not inactive for 16 continuous months.

In the event of a claim you may be required to return to Australia at your own expense for medical treatment or assessment. A benefit may not be payable if you do not return to Australia.



The cost of your insurance

It's important that you're aware of the cost of your insurance. We deduct insurance premiums from your Future Saver account every month, and they will reduce your retirement savings. Since we don't know your specific needs, we encourage you to review your insurance and its cost regularly, to decide whether the level of cover still suits your personal situation, and to make any necessary changes.

The factors that determine the cost

The cost of your cover is based on several factors:

- your age
- your cover type and amount
- your insurance category
- any premium loadings the insurer applies.

For IP cover, your waiting period and your benefit period are also taken into account.

Your age

Your age is one factor in determining your insurance premium.

Premium rates are the same for age-based and fixed cover. The cost of cover differs for death cover, TPD cover and IP cover.

Premium rates are shown on pages 18 and 20.

Premium rates for all types of cover can increase as you get older. This means that your insurance premium can change every year on your birthday.

Your cover type and amount

If you have age-based death and TPD cover, such as Basic Cover and Basic Plus Cover, your cover amounts increase each year until age 35. From age 41, your cover amounts decrease until cover ends at age 70. Refer to **Table 1** for age-based cover on page 18.

If you have fixed death and TPD cover:

- your death cover remains the same each year until it ends at age 70.
- your TPD cover remains the same until you reach age 61. Your cover reduces in equal amounts each year from age 61 until it ends at age 70. If you take up fixed TPD cover after your 61st birthday, your TPD cover reduces in equal amounts each year from your next birthday until it ends at age 70.

Your IP cover can only be taken up as fixed cover, and it remains the same each year until it ends at age 65.

The more cover you have, the more it costs.

Premium waivers

In certain scenarios, your insurance premiums may be waived for a period of time.

Severe financial hardship

If you meet the Severe Financial Hardship criteria as determined by the trustee, we'll automatically apply an insurance premium waiver on the nominated Future Saver account for 12 continuous months from the date of your severe financial hardship payment, subject to certain eligibility requirements. For more information on the insurance premium waiver, including the terms and the eligibility requirements. see page 22.

Employer approved parental leave

If you're due to start or have started your employer approved Parental Leave, you can apply to have your insurance premiums waived for 12 continuous months on your nominated Future Saver account, subject to certain eligibility requirements. For more information on the insurance premium waiver, including the terms and the eligibility requirements, see page 22.

During receipt of IP benefits

If you are receiving IP benefits, premiums for your IP cover will be waived from the end of the waiting period up until the date your IP benefits cease.

Your insurance category

When you apply for cover, the insurer will assign an insurance category to you, based on your occupation. There are 4 insurance categories – the **Professional** category provides the lowest premium and premiums increase through the **Low Risk, Medium Risk** and **High Risk** insurance categories in that order.

If you get Basic Cover automatically and you don't already have an insurance category assigned to you, you'll get the same insurance category as the one that has been assigned to your employer.

An insurance category is assigned to an employer based on their risk profile, their industry and the nature of duties of its workforce.

Any member can apply for the **Professional** insurance category. You must meet several criteria to be eligible for the Professional insurance category (see below).

This table shows the four insurance categories that may apply to you:

Insurance category	Description
Professional	**When the insurance category is based on your occupation:** Your duties are limited to professional, managerial, administrative, clerical 'white collar' duties undertaken in an office environment for at least 90% of regular working hours, or managerial duties in an educational setting; and You belong to a professional association, have a university degree relevant to your profession, or you are a senior manager or executive in a company with at least 10 employees; and You have an annual income of at least $100,000 per year (excluding SG contributions, bonuses and packaged items), which is pro-rated in the case of permanent part-time employees. If you are self-employed, your annual income does not include your share of business expenses or ongoing business income. Annual Income means the gross annual income earned from your main occupation, or occupations, over the 12 months immediately prior to the application date. If you have been employed or self-employed for less than 12 months before the application date, your gross income will be based on the amount earned over the period since they last started employment or self-employment. You must apply and be accepted by the insurer to be in this category.
Low Risk	**When the insurance category is based on your occupation:** Your duties are limited to professional, managerial, educational, administrative, clerical 'white collar' duties undertaken in an office or classroom environment for at least 90% of regular working hours. **When the insurance category is based on your employer's workforce:** The employer's workforce mainly includes employees who qualify for the Low Risk insurance category based on their occupation, with a limited proportion of employees in the Medium Risk and the High Risk insurance categories if assessed based on their individual occupation. The employer's workforce may comprise employees who would qualify for Professional, Low Risk, Medium Risk or High Risk if assessed individually.
Medium Risk	**When the insurance category is based on your occupation:** Your duties include regular light manual work (light weight-lifting, carrying or stocking only), including skilled technicians. You may perform low risk or professional duties outside an office or classroom environment for more than 10% of regular working hours and you do not engage in manual work. Your duties are not performed in a hazardous environment and there is no use of heavy machinery or heavy equipment. **When the insurance category is based on your employer's workforce:** The employer's workforce mainly includes employees who qualify for the Low Risk and Medium Risk insurance categories based on their occupation, with a limited proportion of employees in the High Risk insurance category if assessed based on their individual occupation. The employer's workforce may comprise employees who would qualify for Professional, Low Risk, Medium Risk or High Risk if assessed individually.
High Risk	**When the insurance category is based on your occupation:** Your duties are mainly manual or heavy manual work. Your duties can include the use of heavy machinery/equipment and working in hazardous environments. This category includes roles in Emergency Services. **When the insurance category is based on your employer's workforce:** The employer's workforce does not qualify for the Low Risk or Medium Risk insurance category. The employer's workforce may comprise employees who would qualify for Professional, Low Risk, Medium Risk or High Risk if assessed individually.

Getting the right insurance category

If you get Basic Cover automatically and you don't already have an insurance category assigned to you, you'll get the same insurance category as the one that has been assigned to your employer.

If your job is different from other workers in the organisation where you work (e.g. you work in the head office of a mining company and don't use heavy machinery), the insurance category assigned to you based on your employer may not align to your occupation. In these situations, you should apply for a review of your insurance category by logging into Member Online and going to the 'Insurance' tab.

If an insurance category for your employer can't be assigned to you for any reason, you'll get the Medium Risk insurance category.

Premium loadings

A premium loading is an extra amount the insurer charges if you have health conditions or a lifestyle that increases the chance you might make a claim. Your confirmation of cover letter shows any premium loadings that apply to your cover (see 'About exclusions and loadings' on page 34).

Insurance administration fee

In addition to your insurance premiums, we deduct an insurance administration fee of $1.85 from your Future Saver account at the end of each month, if you have any death cover, TPD cover or IP cover on the last day of that month. This helps cover the cost of managing all of our members' insurance.

This fee won't be charged for the first 60 days if you only hold Basic Cover that was issued to you automatically.

How to work out the annual cost of your cover

This section shows you how to work out the annual premium (or cost) for your insurance. You may prefer to access the insurance calculator on our website which can also help you work out how much insurance you may need and how much it could cost.

Death and TPD cover

Death and TPD cover have different costs, so if you have both types of cover, you'll need to do this calculation once for death cover and again for TPD cover, then add the two amounts together to get your total cost.

If you have Basic Cover, we have already worked out the annual premium for you – see page 6.

Step 1 – Get your numbers

1. If you have **age-based cover**:

   Look up **Table 1**: *Age-based (death and TPD) cover* scale (page 18) to find the standard age-based cover amount for your age. If you have a multiple of age-based cover other than 1 (Basic Cover has a multiple of 1), use that multiple of the scale to calculate your cover amount.

   If you have **fixed cover**:
   Your cover amount is the amount of fixed cover you hold.

   Some members have different multiples of age-based cover, or different levels of fixed cover, for death and TPD (although the TPD cover amount can never be higher than the death cover amount). If this applies to you, you'll need to take those differences into account by calculating your death cover amount separately from your TPD cover amount.

2. In **Table 2**: *Annual death and TPD premium rates* (page 18), find your age and cover type and note the premium rate for each $1,000 of cover. If you have both death and TPD cover, you'll need to note the premium rate for each type of cover separately.

3. In **Table 3**: *Insurance category factors* (page 18), find your insurance category factor. If you have both death and TPD cover, you'll need to note the insurance category factor for each type of cover separately.

Step 2 – Apply the formula

1. Divide your cover amount by 1,000.
2. Multiply the result by the premium rate from **Table 2**.
3. Multiply that result by your insurance category factor from **Table 3**.
4. If the insurer has applied a premium loading to your cover, increase your result by the percentage of premium loading.

The result is the cost of your cover for a year at that age.

Super helpful tip: if you have TPD as well as death cover, you need to repeat this process using the numbers for your TPD cover and add the two results to get your total cost.

Examples – Death and TPD premium calculations

Example

Dina is aged 30 with an insurance category of Low Risk. She had default death and TPD cover in Aware Super before the new insurance arrangements started on 1 May 2023. As a result of the conversion of cover at that date, Dina now has a multiple of 1.72 times the age-based cover scale for death and TPD cover. For her age, this gives her $385,452 of death and TPD cover.

Cover type	Cover amount	$1,000s of cover (divide cover amount by 1,000)	Annual premium per $1,000 of cover	Insurance category factor	Annual premium
Death	$385,452	385.452	× $0.26	× 0.75	$75.16
TPD	$385,452	385.452	× $0.32	× 0.75	$92.51
Total annual cost of death and TPD cover for Dina at age 30					$167.67

Example

Ryan is aged 55 with an insurance category of High Risk. He has chosen death only fixed cover of $250,000.

Cover type	Cover amount	$1,000s of cover (divide cover amount by 1,000)	Annual premium per $1,000 of cover	Insurance category factor	Annual premium
Death	$250,000	250	× $1.63	× 1.40	$570.50
Total annual cost of death cover for Ryan at age 55					$570.50

Example

Hannah is aged 30 with an insurance category of Professional. She has chosen a multiple of 3 times the age-based cover for death cover and 2 times the age-based cover for TPD cover. For her age, this gives her $672,300 of death cover and $448,200 of TPD cover. Due to her health condition as disclosed to the insurer in her application for cover, the insurer has placed a 50% premium loading on her TPD cover.

Cover type	Cover amount	$1,000s of cover (divide cover amount by 1,000)	Annual premium per $1,000 of cover	Insurance category factor	Annual premium (before premium loading)	Premium loading (additional % of premium)	Annual premium
Death	$672,300	672.3	× $0.26	× 0.60	$104.88	-	$104.88
TPD	$448,200	448.2	× $0.32	× 0.50	$71.71	+ $35.86 (50%)	$107.57
Total annual cost of death and TPD cover for Hannah at age 30							$212.45

Table 1: Age-based (death and TPD) cover

This table shows the amount of cover at each age in the age-based cover scale. You can apply for multiples of this scale (see page 32).

Age last birthday	Cover	Age last birthday	Cover
15	$27,000	43	$225,000
16	$40,500	44	$207,900
17	$59,700	45	$191,100
18	$78,900	46	$167,200
19	$87,900	47	$143,400
20	$97,500	48	$124,100
21	$108,300	49	$108,300
22	$120,000	50	$93,600
23	$132,900	51	$78,300
24	$147,000	52	$63,300
25	$164,700	53	$54,000
26	$177,900	54	$45,000
27	$191,100	55	$36,200
28	$203,100	56	$31,800
29	$215,100	57	$27,400
30	$224,100	58	$24,500
31	$232,800	59	$19,000
32	$240,900	60	$16,300
33	$249,000	61	$13,800
34	$255,000	62	$12,600
35	$261,000	63	$12,000
36	$261,000	64	$10,800
37	$261,000	65	$10,000
38	$261,000	66	$10,000
39	$261,000	67	$10,000
40	$261,000	68	$10,000
41	$249,000	69	$10,000
42	$237,000		

Table 2: Annual death and TPD premium rates

This table shows the annual cost (before the tax deduction benefit) for $1,000 of death and TPD cover, before applying the relevant insurance category factor and any premium loading.

Age last birthday	Death	TPD	Age last birthday	Death	TPD
15	$0.14	$0.02	43	$0.48	$1.20
16	$0.17	$0.04	44	$0.53	$1.32
17	$0.21	$0.06	45	$0.58	$1.45
18	$0.23	$0.08	46	$0.63	$1.61
19	$0.26	$0.10	47	$0.68	$1.76
20	$0.27	$0.12	48	$0.75	$1.95
21	$0.26	$0.15	49	$0.81	$2.13
22	$0.26	$0.16	50	$0.89	$2.34
23	$0.26	$0.18	51	$1.00	$2.70
24	$0.26	$0.20	52	$1.12	$3.11
25	$0.26	$0.22	53	$1.27	$3.59
26	$0.26	$0.24	54	$1.43	$4.14
27	$0.26	$0.26	55	$1.63	$4.78
28	$0.26	$0.27	56	$1.84	$5.51
29	$0.26	$0.30	57	$2.07	$6.35
30	$0.26	$0.32	58	$2.35	$7.32
31	$0.26	$0.35	59	$2.65	$8.44
32	$0.26	$0.37	60	$3.00	$9.73
33	$0.26	$0.40	61	$3.38	$11.21
34	$0.26	$0.44	62	$3.83	$12.93
35	$0.27	$0.48	63	$4.32	$14.90
36	$0.29	$0.56	64	$4.89	$17.14
37	$0.31	$0.62	65	$5.42	$17.14
38	$0.34	$0.69	66	$5.91	$17.14
39	$0.36	$0.78	67	$6.43	$17.14
40	$0.38	$0.87	68	$7.01	$17.14
41	$0.41	$0.97	69	$7.65	$17.14
42	$0.45	$1.08			

Table 3: Insurance category factors

	Insurance category factors	
Insurance category	**Death**	**TPD**
Professional	0.60	0.50
Low Risk	0.75	0.75
Medium Risk	1.25	1.25
High Risk	1.40	2.25

Income Protection (IP) cover

Here's how to calculate the annual cost of IP cover.

Step 1 – Get your numbers

1. Find the amount of **annual** IP cover you selected when you applied for cover (if you got your cover automatically under previous fund arrangements, your cover is shown on your annual statement and in Member Online). Note that this calculation uses your **annual** IP cover, not the monthly IP cover that shows on your annual statement and in Member Online.
2. In **Table 4**: *Income Protection annual premium rates* (page 20), find your age and benefit period and note the premium rate.
3. In **Table 5**: *Income Protection insurance category factors* (page 20), find your insurance category factor.
4. In **Table 6**: *Income Protection waiting period factors* (page 20), find your waiting period factor.

Step 2 – Apply the formula

1. Divide your cover amount by 1,000.
2. Multiply the result by the premium rate from **Table 4**.
3. Multiply that result by your insurance category factor from **Table 5**.
4. Multiple that result by your waiting period factor from **Table 6**.
5. If the insurer has applied a premium loading to your cover, increase your result by the percentage of premium loading.

The result is the cost of your cover for a year at that age.

Examples – Income protection premium calculations

Example 1

Ruby is a 36-year-old payroll assistant who has IP cover of $36,000 per year or $3,000 per month, with a 2-year benefit period and a 90-day waiting period. She has an insurance category of Low Risk.

Annual cover amount	$1,000s of cover (divide cover amount by 1,000)	Annual premium per $1,000 of cover	Insurance category factor	Waiting period factor	Annual premium
$36,000 ($3,000 per month)	36	× $1.28	× 1.00	× 1.00	$46.08

Example 2

Amanda is a 30-year-old nurse who has IP cover of $60,000 per year or $5,000 per month, with a 5-year benefit period and a 30-day waiting period. She has an insurance category of Medium Risk. Due to her health condition as disclosed to the insurer in her application for cover, the insurer has placed a 75% premium loading on her cover.

Annual cover amount	$1,000s of cover (divide cover amount by 1,000)	Annual premium per $1,000 of cover	Insurance category factor	Waiting period factor	Annual premium (before premium loading)	Premium loading (additional % of premium)	Annual premium
$60,000 ($5,000 per month)	60	× $2.31	× 1.25	× 2.00	$346.50	+ $259.88 (75%)	$606.38

Table 4: Income Protection annual premium rates (90 days waiting period)

This table shows the **annual** cost (before the tax deduction benefit) for $1,000 of **annual** IP cover with a 90 days waiting period, before applying the relevant insurance category and waiting period factors and any premium loading.

Age last birthday	Benefit period		
	2 years	5 years	To age 65
15	$0.97	$2.29	$4.53
16	$0.98	$2.31	$4.53
17	$1.03	$2.43	$4.53
18	$1.04	$2.44	$4.53
19	$1.04	$2.44	$4.53
20	$1.08	$2.56	$4.53
21	$1.03	$2.43	$4.55
22	$1.00	$2.35	$4.61
23	$0.97	$2.29	$4.68
24	$0.96	$2.28	$4.75
25	$0.92	$2.19	$4.82
26	$0.92	$2.19	$5.09
27	$0.96	$2.28	$5.35
28	$0.97	$2.29	$5.58
29	$0.97	$2.29	$5.80
30	$0.98	$2.31	$6.04
31	$1.02	$2.41	$6.28
32	$1.05	$2.48	$6.53
33	$1.11	$2.62	$6.84
34	$1.14	$2.69	$7.20
35	$1.20	$2.84	$7.62
36	$1.28	$3.03	$8.11
37	$1.39	$3.27	$8.69
38	$1.45	$3.42	$9.36
39	$1.54	$3.63	$10.13

Age last birthday	Benefit period		
	2 years	5 years	To age 65
40	$1.65	$3.90	$11.00
41	$1.78	$4.20	$11.98
42	$1.90	$4.48	$13.06
43	$2.08	$4.91	$14.27
44	$2.25	$5.30	$15.57
45	$2.44	$5.78	$16.99
46	$2.69	$6.36	$18.49
47	$2.95	$6.96	$20.05
48	$3.29	$7.77	$21.71
49	$3.66	$8.65	$23.40
50	$4.09	$9.65	$25.11
51	$4.59	$10.84	$26.84
52	$5.15	$12.17	$28.49
53	$5.79	$13.68	$30.09
54	$6.54	$15.45	$31.56
55	$7.37	$17.42	$32.89
56	$8.35	$19.71	$33.90
57	$9.46	$22.35	$34.52
58	$10.73	$25.36	$34.59
59	$12.10	$28.20	$33.93
60	$13.65	$26.92	$32.39
61	$15.39	$24.63	$29.64
62	$17.31	$20.94	$25.20
63	$15.20	$15.86	$19.09
64	$5.48	$5.72	$6.88

Table 5: Income Protection insurance category factors

Insurance category	Insurance category factors
Professional	0.75
Low Risk	1.00
Medium Risk	1.25
High Risk	1.50

Table 6: Income Protection waiting period factors

Waiting period	Waiting period factors
14 days (2 year benefit period only)	2.50
30 days	2.00
60 days	1.50
90 days	1.00

Paying for your insurance

We deduct insurance premiums from your Future Saver account on the last day of each month. The amount we deduct each month varies slightly depending on the number of days in the month. Premiums are deducted in arrears (that is, for insurance held during the month just ended). The fund receives a tax deduction for insurance premiums paid to the insurer. We pass this tax benefit onto you at the time we deduct the premium from your Future Saver account.

If you start, end, increase or decrease your insurance during a month, we'll charge a pro-rata premium based on the number of days you were covered in that month. If you withdraw all your money from your Future Saver account, we deduct any unpaid premiums and fees before paying you the balance.

If insurance premiums are refunded or a Severe Financial Hardship or Parental Leave insurance premium waiver is applied to your Future Saver account, the amount will be net of the tax benefit rebate previously provided. In addition to the insurance premiums, we deduct an insurance administration fee from your Future Saver account at the end of each month, even if you have any type of insurance premium waiver applied to your Future Saver account. We only deduct this if you have any death cover, TPD cover or IP cover on the last day of that month. See 'Insurance administration fee' on page 16 for details about this fee.

If your account does not have enough money

If there isn't enough money in your Future Saver account on the last day of a month to pay your insurance premiums for that month, we deduct the remaining account balance (so your account is reduced to zero) and your insurance ceases on the last day of that month. We'll write to you to let you know your insurance is going to end.

How to keep your insurance going

We will write to inform that you will have two months ("reinstatement period") from the date your cover ceases to reinstate your cover.

To reinstate ceased cover, we'll use any contribution or rollover paid into your Future Saver account during the reinstatement period to pay your unpaid insurance premiums. Reinstatement of cover will happen automatically once there is enough money in your Future Saver account to pay your unpaid premiums. We'll check this twice:

- once at the end of the first month after your cover ceases: if you have enough money in your Future Saver account at that time to pay all your unpaid premiums up to the end of that month, your cover will be reinstated from the date it ceased; if not
- we'll check your Future Saver account again at the end of the next month (which would be at the end of the two months' reinstatement period): if you have enough money in your Future Saver account at that time to pay all your unpaid premiums up to the end of that month, your cover will be reinstated from the date it ceased.

If your cover is reinstated, any Severe Financial Hardship or Parental Leave insurance premium waiver that may have applied to your cover cannot be reinstated. You'll have to re-apply for the Severe Financial Hardship or Parental Leave insurance premium waiver, subject to the terms and eligibility requirements outlined in the section below.

For more information on the insurance premium waiver, including the terms and the eligibility requirements, see page 22.

If your insurance is not reinstated within the two months' reinstatement period, cover will cease effective from the last day of the month where only a part premium (that is, not the full month's premium) was paid. If you later want insurance again, you'll have to apply and answer several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle. If this happens there's no guarantee that the insurer will accept your application.

Insurance premium waiver

You may be able to have your insurance premiums waived due to Severe Financial Hardship or employer approved Parental Leave. If you're eligible, this means you can have premium-free insurance cover for 12 continuous months.

Subject to application and acceptance, insurance premiums will be waived for any amount of Death, TPD and/or IP cover held at the time of application, in the nominated Future Saver account. If you later change your amount of insurance, for the types of cover you held at the time of application, during the Premium Waiver Period, all insurance premiums will continue to be waived for the remainder of the Premium Waiver Period. If you apply for a new type of cover during the Premium Waiver Period, that wasn't previously held at the time of application, premiums in respect of that new cover type will not be waived and will be deducted from your applicable Future Saver account balance.

At the end of the Premium Waiver Period premium deductions for any Death, TPD and/or IP cover will recommence as applicable. The insurance administration fee is excluded from the insurance premium waiver and will continue to be deducted from your Future Saver account.

Severe financial hardship insurance premium waiver

If you meet the Severe Financial Hardship criteria as determined by the trustee, we'll automatically apply an insurance premium waiver on the nominated Future Saver account for 12 continuous months from the date of your Severe Financial Hardship payment. Generally, this is when a person is unable to meet reasonable and immediate family living expenses. You can have a total of two Severe Financial Hardship insurance premium waivers during your membership.

Employer approved parental leave insurance premium waiver

If you're due to start or have started employer approved Parental Leave, you can apply to have your insurance premiums waived for 12 continuous months from the date we receive and approve your application on your nominated Future Saver account. You'll need to make a declaration that your employer has approved your Parental Leave as part of your application. You can log into Member Online, select the 'Insurance' tab and complete the online application at any time. You can have a total of two Parental Leave insurance premium waivers during your membership.

The insurance premium waiver cannot be backdated, so you won't be able to apply for the parental leave insurance premium waiver if your Parental Leave has already ended.

This table shows who is eligible for the insurance premium waiver, how it will be applied and when it will commence and end.

	Insurance premium waiver due to Parental Leave[1]	Insurance premium waiver due to Severe Financial Hardship[2]
Eligibility criteria	Have current insurance cover with Aware Super. Have been an Aware Super member for 12 continuous months. Have not already commenced any insurance premium waiver in the nominated Future Saver account during the last 12 months.	
	Have not received two Parental Leave insurance premium waivers previously. Are Employed and have employer-approved Parental Leave, that has not ended (excludes Self-Employed members).	Have not received two Severe Financial Hardship insurance premium waivers previously. Meet the Severe Financial Hardship criteria as determined by the trustee.
When the insurance premium waiver begins	From the date we receive and approve the application. You can complete the *Application for parental leave insurance premium waiver* via Member Online or via a PDF form, available on request.	From the date of the Severe Financial Hardship payment. You can complete the *Application for the early release of benefits on the grounds of severe financial hardship* via Member Online or via a PDF form that you can download from our website.
When the insurance premium waiver ends	• 12 continuous months from the date we receive and approve your application; or • when all the insurance cover that the premium waiver was applied to is cancelled or ceases; or • when the account that the premium waiver is applied to reaches a zero-dollar balance; or • when you exit the fund.	• 12 continuous months from the date of the Severe Financial Hardship payment; or • when all the insurance cover that the premium waiver was applied to is cancelled or ceases; or • when the account that the premium waiver is applied to reaches a zero-dollar balance; or • when you exit the fund.

[1] As at the date of the application.

[2] As at the date we approve the early release of the superannuation benefit.



Types of cover

About death and terminal illness cover

Death cover

If you die, we pay your death benefit to your beneficiary or beneficiaries. Your death benefit comprises any amount of insured death benefit we receive for you from the insurer, along with your Future Saver account balance. If you have a valid binding death benefit nomination, we pay the death benefit in accordance with your nomination.

A binding death benefit nominated beneficiary must be either a dependant or your legal personal representative of your estate. If you haven't nominated any eligible beneficiaries, we decide who will be paid the death benefit. You can nominate binding death benefit beneficiaries at any time by logging into Member Online and going to the 'Profile' tab, or downloading the relevant form from our website. See 'Death claims' on page 38 for information about claims and beneficiaries. For more information about beneficiaries and how to nominate beneficiaries, see the *Super Handbook* on our website at **aware.com.au/pds**.

Example

Death claim

Jeremy is a 52-year-old librarian, married to Ninetta. They have one child, Ricardo, who is 18. Jeremy has $63,300 of death cover and a super balance of $536,700, meaning he has a total death benefit of $600,000. He's made a valid binding death benefit nomination naming Ninetta and Ricardo as beneficiaries to get 50% each.

If Jeremy dies, we'll pay Ninetta and Ricardo $300,000 each, less any tax (where $300,000 is half of the $63,300 insurance benefit plus half of the $536,700 super account balance).

If you're diagnosed with a terminal illness

If you're diagnosed with a terminal illness, we pay the death benefit amount on your date of terminal illness to you (a maximum of $5 million applies, even if your death cover is higher). The insurer considers you to have a terminal illness if two medical practitioners (one who is a specialist practicing in the area of your Illness or Injury) certify that you have an Illness or Injury that is likely to cause your death within 24 months of the date of certification, despite reasonable medical treatment.

Example

Terminal illness claim

James is a 55 year-old who owns a café and is married with three children. He has death (including terminal illness) and TPD cover of $600,000. When his doctor diagnoses that he has colon cancer, James consults an oncologist and starts chemotherapy. Following unsuccessful treatment, James' doctor and his oncologist certify to us that he's unlikely to live more than 24 months.

Based on the medical evidence, the insurer approves the claim and pays the death cover of $600,000 to us for deposit into James' Future Saver account. Now he has enough money to pay off his home and get his finances in order to support his wife and children before he dies.

Loyalty Bonus

If you keep your death cover in the fund continuously for at least 8 years,[1] we'll increase your death (and terminal illness) cover by the lesser of 5% of the sum insured or $25,000 at the time of claim, provided that you have not previously received an insured terminal illness benefit from the fund. This is a one-off increase to your cover, at no additional cost to you.

When the insurer won't pay a death or terminal illness benefit

The insurer will not pay a death or terminal illness benefit if death or terminal illness is a direct or indirect result of:

- your participation in terrorism; or
- an act of war while you're actively participating in that war; or
- suicide or intentional self-inflicted illness or injury, if your cover started or increased due to a life event – this only applies for the first 13 months after your cover starts, increases or is reinstated; or
- an individual exclusion that applies to your cover.

[1] The 8 year continuous cover period does not include insured periods where cover was held under different funds or insurance policies. For cover transferred to Aware Super under successor fund transfers the 8 year continuous cover period starts:

- for former VicSuper members, no earlier than 1 July 2020;
- for former WA Super members, no earlier than 4 December 2020;
- for former VISSF members, no earlier than 1 December 2021.



About total and permanent disablement (TPD) cover

The term total and permanent disablement (TPD) has a specific meaning in the policy. The description here is only an overview of the key features of the TPD definition.

If you submit a TPD claim, the insurer will apply the full policy definition.

What factors are considered when assessing someone for TPD?

The full definition of TPD can be found in 'What the words mean' on page 46.

The following is a guide to some of the key factors that are considered if you are being assessed for TPD.

If there is any inconsistency between the following guide and the full definition in the policy, the full definition in the policy prevails.

Some of the key factors **(but not all the factors)** that will be considered by the insurer are outlined below.

1. Employment

- If you were in gainful employment when you became disabled, you must have ceased all work-related duties due to Illness or Injury, as certified by a medical practitioner

  or

- If you were not in gainful employment when you became disabled, you must have ceased to be able to engage in gainful employment due to Illness or Injury, as certified by a medical practitioner

2. Your medical condition and how long you have been unable to work

- If you haven't been able to work because of a specific medical condition, you must have been continuously unable to work from the date you were disabled until the date the insurer makes a decision

  or

- If it's not a specific medical condition that's preventing you from working, you must have been unable to work from the date you were disabled for a continuous period of 3 months and continuously since then, until the date the insurer makes a decision.

  (For the continuous period of 3 months, the insurer will ignore up to two unsuccessful attempts of less than 30 days each to return to work.)

3. Your treatment

- You must be under the care of a health professional whose educational qualifications and specialty are appropriate for your Illness or Injury, at a frequency that is appropriate for your medical condition, and you are following their advice.
- You must have tried all reasonable and appropriate treatment options, including rehabilitation and interventions for your Illness or Injury.

4. Your future ability to work

The insurer must consider whether, due to your Illness or Injury, you're unlikely ever to engage in any work for which you're reasonably qualified by your education, training or experience.

The insurer will also consider:

- if your cover was subject to any limitations or exclusions;
- any evidence that they consider is reasonably necessary to form their opinion and is reasonably available to them up until the date they form their opinion;
- medical advice, the advice of a specialist medical practitioner appointed by them, the advice of other experts (medical or otherwise) and any other information that they consider to be appropriate and relevant at the date when they form their opinion;
- any retraining, work, voluntary work or rehabilitation that you could reasonably undertake or have already undertaken, as well as any further reasonable treatments (medical or otherwise) or medication reasonably available that could enable you to return to work in the future;
- your capacity to work, and without limiting the concept of work to work that is available in your local area.

Example

TPD claim

Emily is a 43-year-old nurse who has $450,000 of death and TPD cover. She has a car accident and is severely injured and paralysed. She's hospitalised and goes into full medical treatment and rehabilitation, but with no improvement in her condition after 3 months of treatment, Emily makes a TPD claim.

Emily's situation is assessed as follows:

1. She had to stop working because of her injury.
2. She wasn't able to work for a continuous period of three months because of her injury.
3. She had ongoing medical treatment and tried all reasonable rehabilitation and intervention.
4. Her doctors and the insurer concluded that she's unlikely ever again to do any job she's suited to by her education, training or experience.

After reviewing all the evidence and consulting their own specialists, the insurer decides that Emily meets the TPD definition and pays $450,000 to the trustee for deposit into her Future Saver account, enabling her to re-fit her home to suit a wheelchair, pay toward assistance support and make investments to provide an income.

When the insurer won't pay a TPD benefit

The insurer will not pay a TPD benefit if TPD is a direct or indirect result of:

- your participation in terrorism; or
- an act of war while you're actively participating in that war; or
- suicide or intentional self-inflicted illness or injury, if your cover started or increased due to a life event – this only applies for the first 13 months after your cover starts, increases or is reinstated; or
- an individual exclusion that applies to your cover.

About income protection (IP) cover

Income protection (IP) makes monthly payments to you if you can't work because you're totally disabled or partially disabled by Illness or Injury.

You do not automatically receive IP cover when you become a member of Aware Super. If you apply for IP cover, you must make some choices:

- how much you would like the insurer to pay you if you become disabled (cover amount)
- when payments should start after you become disabled (waiting period)
- how long payments should continue while you're disabled (benefit period).

Who can have IP cover?

You can apply for IP cover if you have money in your Future Saver account and you are:

- an Australian Resident
- at least 15 years old but less than 65
- gainfully employed for at least 15 hours per week, and
- at work on the date you apply.

You don't need to have death or TPD cover to apply for IP cover. Any application for IP cover must be assessed and approved by the insurer before cover is provided.

How much IP cover can you have?

You should consider how much IP cover you need and whether it is appropriate to your financial circumstances. You can apply to change your IP cover at any time (see 'Changing your insurance' on page 32). Your monthly IP cover can be any amount between 15% and 87% of your normal monthly income, subject to the policy maximum limit.

Note that if you make a successful IP claim, the insurer will need to accept that you are totally disabled and will only pay up to 75% of your pre-disability income to you as income, and subject to a maximum of your IP cover. If you choose an amount of cover higher than 75% (up to a maximum monthly benefit of 87%) the insurer pays the amount above 75% to us for deposit into your Future Saver account as a superannuation contribution.

IP benefit payments will never be more than your IP cover amount. Payments are taxed as income, so tax may be deducted from your IP benefit before it is paid to you.

If you are receiving Other Disability Income because of your Illness or Injury, such as workers' compensation payments or disability income benefits from the government, your IP benefit may be reduced as a result of those payments. See 'Offsetting other payments' on page 29.

Applying for IP cover

You can apply for IP cover at any time. It can be obtained in a few different ways:

- as part of an application for Basic Plus Cover
- through IP Express
- with full underwriting.

You can log into Member Online, select the 'Insurance' tab and complete the online application at any time.

IP as part of Basic Plus Cover or IP Express Cover

If you don't already have IP cover, you can apply for it as part of an application for Basic Plus Cover or IP Express Cover.

When you apply, you will need to answer several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle. You will be asked for your current occupation so that the most relevant insurance category can be assigned to you. If you apply online, you'll be told immediately if your application has been accepted.

IP cover taken up as part of Basic Plus Cover or IP Express is available with a 60 or 90-day waiting period and a 2 or 5-year benefit period. You can nominate the level of cover you want, up to 87% of your normal monthly income, subject to limits based on your insurance category, as follows:

Insurance category (based on your occupation)	Maximum IP Cover under Basic Plus or IP Express (per month)
Professional	$20,000
Low Risk	$15,000
Medium Risk	$10,000
High Risk	$7,000

IP with full underwriting

If you want to apply for more cover than Basic Plus Cover or IP Express offers, or you want to choose a different waiting period or benefit period, you can complete a full online application, which the insurer will assess before deciding whether they can cover you, and if so on what terms and at what cost.

When IP benefit payments start (waiting period)

The waiting period is the number of days that must pass after your date of disablement before benefit payments can start. You must be continuously disabled during the period (and totally disabled for at least 7 out of 12 consecutive days during the waiting period).

The insurer doesn't make any payments during the waiting period. If the insurer approves your claim, they start paying your IP benefit payments after the waiting period ends.

Waiting period options

When applying for IP cover, you must choose one of the following waiting periods:

- 14 days (only available for a 2-year benefit period option)
- 30 days
- 60 days
- 90 days.

Full underwriting will be required to apply for IP cover with a 14 or 30 day waiting period (see 'IP with full underwriting').

The shorter the waiting period, the more your cover costs.

Total or partial disability?

For the insurer to approve your IP claim, they'll need to determine whether you're totally disabled or partially disabled during and after the waiting period.

If the insurer has concluded that you are totally disabled, benefit payments start if the insurer determines:

- the waiting period has ended;
- during the waiting period, you were totally disabled for at least 7 out of 12 consecutive days; and
- you are not earning any income due to your total disability.

If the insurer has concluded that you are partially disabled, benefit payments start if the insurer determines:

- the waiting period has ended;
- during the waiting period you were totally disabled for at least 7 out of 12 consecutive days; and
- you are earning less than your pre-disability income due to your partial disability.

How long the insurer keeps paying you (benefit period)

When applying for IP cover, you must choose a benefit period of either **2 years**, **5 years** or **to age 65**. This is the maximum length of time during which the insurer may pay you a monthly benefit while you're disabled. Full underwriting will be required to apply for IP cover with an age 65 benefit period, or a 14 or 30 day waiting period (see 'IP with full underwriting').

	Waiting period options			
Benefit period	**14 days**	**30 days**	**60 days**	**90 days**
2 years	✔	✔	✔	✔
5 years	Not available	✔	✔	✔
To age 65	Not available	✔	✔	✔

The longer the benefit period, the more your cover costs.

Indexation of IP benefits

If your benefit period is 5 years or to age 65, and you have been paid IP benefits for a continuous period of 12 months or more, the insurer will increase your benefit on each anniversary date by the lesser of 5% and the increase in the CPI (minimum 0%), subject to the Maximum Cover Limit.

When IP benefit payments end

If your claim for IP benefits is accepted, monthly payments are paid to you by the insurer.

The insurer will stop payments to you on the date that the first of any of these events happen:

- you're no longer totally disabled or partially disabled
- the end of your chosen benefit period
- you reach age 65
- the insurer believes that you have made a fraudulent claim
- you refuse to undertake treatment or rehabilitation which, in the insurer's opinion, could help you return to work in an increased capacity
- you refuse to return to Australia after the insurer has asked you to return from overseas for ongoing assessment of your claim
- you die.

Suspending payments

The insurer will suspend benefit payments if:

- you go to prison for committing a criminal act, or
- you refuse to go to a medical examination or provide any evidence such as medical, financial or other evidence as requested by the insurer.

Your benefit period continues while payments are suspended (as if payments are still being made), and the insurer won't make back-payments for payments you miss during a suspension.

Calculating partial disability benefits

If you are partially disabled, you will be earning some income from employment, but not as much as normal because you are not back to your normal working hours. In this case, the insurer will only pay you a reduced amount of IP benefit, taking account of the income that you are earning.

Your partial disability benefit (before applying any offsets) is calculated using this formula:

$$\frac{\text{Pre-disability income} - \text{Return to employment income}}{\text{Pre-disability income}} \times \text{Partial Monthly Benefit}$$

See Example 4 on the next page for how this works.

Offsetting other payments

If you become disabled, you might be entitled to Other Disability Income which includes payments from other sources such as workers' compensation and motor accident insurance. The insurer needs to take those other payments into account before deciding how much to pay you, as there are maximum limits on how much you can be paid due to your Illness or Injury.

If you are totally disabled and the total of all the payments you get during a month (including our IP payments) is more than 87% of your pre-disability income, the insurer will reduce your monthly payment until the total from all sources is no more than 87% of your pre-disability income.

If you are partially disabled and the total of all the payments you get during a month (including our IP payments and your return to employment income) is more than 95% of your pre-disability income, the insurer will reduce your partial disability payment until the total from all sources is no more than 95% of your pre-disability income.

If you are entitled to a partial disability benefit, it will be paid to you as follows:

- 90% of the partial disability benefit will be paid to you as income
- 10% of the partial disability benefit will be paid into your Future Saver account as a superannuation contribution.

IP benefit payments are always subject to a maximum of the amount of IP cover you have.

Income protection benefit examples

Example 1

Total disability, no other income, benefit is all income, no superannuation

Jack has an annual salary of $60,000 (excluding SG contributions) and $3,000 per month of IP cover in the fund. He becomes totally disabled due to illness and is not receiving any other income as a result of his disability.

The maximum benefit the insurer will pay is the **lesser of** his IP cover and 87% of his salary – that is, the lesser of $36,000 per annum (or $3,000 per month) and $52,200 per annum (or $4,350 per month). So his benefit will be $3,000 per month.

The maximum benefit as income is the **lesser of** his IP cover and 75% of his salary – that is, the lesser of $36,000 per annum (or $3,000 per month) and $45,000 per annum (or $3,750 per month). So his maximum benefit as income will be $3,000 per month.

Result: Jack will get $3,000 per month income (less any tax). No superannuation contribution will apply.

Example 2

Total disability, other income, benefit is income plus superannuation

Lisbeth has an annual salary of $100,000 (excluding SG contributions) and $3,000 per month of IP cover in the fund. She becomes totally disabled in a work accident and is receiving $4,000 per month in workers compensation. She is not receiving any other income as a result of her disability.

The maximum benefit from all income sources is 87% of her salary – that is, $87,000 per annum (or $7,250 per month) and the maximum allowable benefit as income is 75% of her salary – that is, $75,000 per annum (or $6,250 per month).

Her monthly IP cover in the fund ($3,000) plus her monthly workers compensation payments ($4,000) equals $7,000 which is under the maximum limit of $7,250, so Lisbeth will be entitled to the full $3,000 per month benefit from the insurer. However she cannot get it all as income, as otherwise her total income from all sources ($7,000) would exceed the income limit allowed ($6,250 per month) by $750. Therefore, the insurer will reduce their payment to her by $750 and pay that amount to us for deposit into her Future Saver account as a superannuation contribution.

Result: Lisbeth will get her full monthly IP cover amount ($3,000) but it will be paid as $2,250 income (less any tax) plus $750 superannuation contribution.

Example 3

Total disability, other income, total benefits exceed maximum allowed

Jane has an annual salary of $120,000 (excluding SG contributions) and $8,700 per month of IP cover in the fund. She becomes totally disabled in a car accident and is receiving $4,000 per month in transport accident benefits. She is also receiving $2,000 per month from another income protection policy outside of the fund. The maximum benefit from all income sources is 87% of her salary – that is, $104,400 per annum (or $8,700 per month) and the maximum allowable benefit as income is 75% of her salary – that is, $90,000 per annum (or $7,500 per month). Her monthly cover in the fund ($8,700) plus her transport accident payments ($4,000) plus her non-Aware Super IP policy benefit ($2,000) equals $14,700 which is $6,000 over the maximum limit of $8,700. Therefore Jane will not be entitled to get a benefit from Aware Super equal to her full IP cover amount. It must be reduced by $6,000 and the insurer will only pay her a benefit of $2,700.

Jane cannot get it all as income because otherwise her total income from all sources ($8,700) would exceed the income limit allowed ($7,500) by $1,200. Therefore the insurer will reduce the payment it makes directly to her by $1,200 and pay that amount to us for deposit into her Future Saver account as a superannuation contribution.

Result: Jane will not get her IP cover amount in full, because her other income is too high. Her benefit of $2,700 will be paid to her as $1,500 income (less any tax) plus $1,200 superannuation contribution. However it should be noted that her total monthly income from all sources will be $4,000 + $2,000 + $1,500 = $7,500 which is the maximum allowed across all income sources. When you add the $1,200 that the insurer pays as a superannuation contribution, her total benefit from all sources is $8,700, which is the overall total benefit allowed under the Aware Super policy.

Note: In this example, Jane's cover in Aware Super was reduced partly because she had another IP policy outside of the fund. Based on her current salary, Jane may be over insured and should carefully consider whether she needs to keep both her Aware Super IP cover and her non-Aware Super IP cover, as she may be paying premiums for cover that she cannot claim full benefits from.

Example 4

Partial disability, other income from employment

Lucy has an annual salary of $150,000 or $12,500 per month (excluding SG contributions) and $9,000 per month of IP cover in the fund. She has been receiving an IP benefit of $9,000 per month after being totally disabled but she is now back at work 2 days a week, on a rehabilitation program, having previously been working 5 days a week. So she is now earning $60,000 per annum (or $5,000 per month) from working.

Provided that the insurer assesses her as being partially disabled, the insurer will only pay her a reduced amount of IP benefit, due to the income that she is now earning from being back at work in a reduced capacity. The reduced monthly benefit will be: (($12,500 – $5,000) / $12,500) × $9,000 = $5,400.

Her monthly benefit from the fund ($5,400) plus her monthly income from working ($5,000) equals $10,400 which is under the maximum limit of 95% of her pre-disability income (95% of $12,500 = $11,875).

Result: Lucy will be entitled to $5,400 per month benefit from the fund, which will be paid to her as follows:

- 90% or $4,860 per month will be paid to her as income (in addition to the $5,000 per month she is earning from working 2 days a week less any applicable tax).
- 10% or $540 per month will be paid into her Future Saver account as a superannuation contribution.

If you take leave without pay

If you take employer approved leave without pay, your cover continues while you're on leave, if you have enough money in your account to pay for the premiums each month.

Occupation and income while you're on leave without pay

While you're on leave without pay, your occupation is deemed to be the occupation you were doing before you went on leave.

The insurer will calculate your pre-disability income over the 12 months before you went on leave, if:

- your employer approved the leave in writing before you went on leave or, if you're self-employed, you made arrangements for your business to continue and you don't earn any income from it while you're on leave; and
- you plan to return to work within 24 months (maximum period of cover during leave without pay).

If you don't meet the above conditions, the insurer will calculate your pre-disability income over the 12 months immediately before you became disabled.

Payments if you're totally disabled while you're on leave without pay

If you become totally disabled while you're on leave without pay and the insurer approves your claim, payments won't start until the last of these events happens:

- the end of the waiting period
- if you're employed, the date you agreed with your employer that you would return to work
- if you're self-employed, the end of the leave period you arranged with whoever is running your business while you're on leave.

If you're disabled again

If you return to gainful employment and later have a recurring disability (a disability that keeps happening for the same or a related reason when you are still covered for IP), the insurer may consider this to be a continuation of your previous disability and claim.

If your disability is deemed by the insurer to be a continuation of an earlier period of disability, the original period of disability and each recurrent period of disability will be treated as a continuous period in determining the benefit period, and

- if the period of recurrent disability starts within 6 months of the date that your last IP benefit payment ceased, the waiting period will be waived (that is, there will be no further waiting period to receive an IP benefit during that period of recurrent disability); or
- if the period of recurrent disability starts 6 or more months after the date that your last IP benefit payment ceased, a new waiting period will apply before any IP benefit is payable.

If, after the expiry of the benefit period, you return to gainful employment for a minimum of 15 hours per week, for a continuous period of at least 6 months and you subsequently become disabled again as a result of the same or a related Illness or Injury, a new waiting period and benefit period will apply.

When the insurer won't pay an IP benefit

The insurer will not pay an IP benefit if your disability is a direct or indirect result of:

- suicide or intentional self-inflicted illness or injury; or
- your participation in terrorism; or
- an act of war; or
- service in the armed forces of any country.

If you die while receiving IP payments

If you die while receiving monthly IP payments, a one-off lump sum payment will be paid into your Future Saver account equal to three times your monthly IP benefit. This amount is reduced by the total of any IP payments made after you died.

Example

IP death benefit

Benzir is receiving a monthly IP payment of $2,000 when he dies. His lump sum death benefit is three times his monthly IP benefit, or $6,000. However his relatives only notify us of his death two months later, and by then two monthly payments have been made to him for the period after his death (not being aware that he'd died). This reduces the lump sum by $4,000 for the two payments made after his death.



Changing your insurance

You can apply for new cover or change your existing cover at any time. We'll send you written confirmation when any changes take effect.

The quickest way to change your cover is to log into your account and request the change online. If you don't have online access, call us on **1300 650 873**.

For example, if you have Basic Cover you could:

- upgrade to Basic Plus Cover
- apply for IP cover
- change your Basic Cover to fixed cover, or choose any multiple of the age-based death and TPD cover scale.

If you have fixed death only cover, or fixed death and TPD cover, you can apply to convert it to age-based cover at any time (IP cover can only be fixed cover and cannot be converted to age-based cover).

There is plenty of flexibility to apply for the level of cover that best suits your needs.

Applying for age-based death and TPD cover

You can apply for age-based death and TPD cover, or death only cover, at any time, as long as the amount you choose is a multiple of the age-based cover scale equal to 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, 2.5 and so on, within the policy's Maximum Cover Limits and subject to the insurer's acceptance.

You might consider increasing your cover if your financial circumstances change and you have more debts or dependants (e.g. you take out a home loan or have a child).

If you have Basic Cover, you can upgrade to Basic Plus Cover to double your death and TPD cover amounts. Basic Plus Cover gives you an additional 1 times the automatic age-based scale for death and TPD cover, on top of your Basic Cover. You cannot apply for Basic Plus Cover if you have already reduced your Basic Cover, or have converted your Basic Cover to fixed cover. You can also apply for Basic Plus Cover if you have no cover.

When you apply, the insurer asks you several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle. On the basis of your answers, the insurer decides whether or not to accept your application and may apply exclusions or loadings (see 'About exclusions and loadings' on page 34).

The maximum amounts of cover you can have are:

Cover type	Maximum Cover Limits
Death	unlimited
Terminal illness	$5 million
TPD	$5 million

The more you increase your cover, the more your cover costs.

Example

Increasing your cover

Sarah is a 30-year-old manager with Basic Cover ($224,100 at her age). After having twins, Sarah decides she needs more death and TPD cover and considers upgrading to Basic Plus Cover, which would increase her original Basic Cover to double the amount (to $448,200). Wanting more than Basic Plus Cover, Sarah applies to increase to three times her original Basic Cover amount (to $672,300). Sarah answers employment, health and lifestyle questions in her application and the insurer approves the increased amount. This also increases the cost of Sarah's cover.

Applying for fixed cover

You can apply for fixed death only cover, or fixed death and TPD cover, at any time. You can do this online.

If you already have Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover or any multiple of age-based death and TPD cover, you can convert it to fixed cover at any time. When you apply for fixed cover online, we'll change all your existing cover to fixed cover. Your death cover amount will stay the same regardless of your age until it expires at age 70, and your TPD cover will remain the same until it starts tapering (reducing) in equal amounts from your 61st birthday (see 'Your TPD cover automatically reduces from age 61' on page 5).

The cost of fixed cover increases with your age.

Changing your IP cover

You can apply for IP cover, or change the following aspects of your existing IP cover, at any time. You can do all this online:

- cover amount – this must be between 15% and 87% of your normal monthly income (a Maximum Cover Limit of $40,000 per month applies)
- waiting period
- benefit period.

Increasing your cover amount, choosing a shorter waiting period or a longer benefit period increases the cost of your cover.

Interim accident cover

If you are required to complete a full personal statement when applying for cover (that is, you are asked questions about your employment, health and lifestyle and the insurer does not make a decision immediately), you'll have interim accident cover while your application is being assessed by the insurer.

Interim accident cover starts when the insurer receives your fully completed personal statement and application for cover and ends on the earliest date on which any of these things happen:

- you stop being a member of the fund or eligible for insurance in the fund
- you withdraw your application for cover
- the insurer accepts or declines your application for cover, or advises you that your interim accident cover has ended
- 90 days after the insurer has received your fully completed personal statement.

Interim accident cover does not apply when a full personal statement is not completed (such as when transferring cover to the fund or you apply for Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover, Life Events cover or IP cover through IP Express).

Interim accident cover is:

- **for death cover**, the lesser of the following amounts when death is caused solely, directly and independently of any other cause, by an accident, as long as death occurs within 365 days of the accident:
  - the amount of cover applied for; and
  - $2 million
- **for TPD cover**, the lesser of the following amounts when TPD is caused solely, directly and independently of any other cause, by an accident, as long as TPD occurs within 365 days of the accident:
  - the amount of cover applied for; and
  - $1 million less any existing TPD cover

- **for IP cover**, the lesser of the following amounts when total disability or partial disability is caused solely, directly and independently of any other cause, by an accident, and you remain totally disabled or partially disabled after the waiting period for which you have applied:
  - the amount of cover applied for, less any benefit you are entitled to receive from existing IP cover in the fund; and
  - $10,000 per month.

If you make a claim for interim accident cover for IP, the amount payable to you will be calculated for Total Disability or Partial Disability (see page 28) taking into account your interim accident cover amount insured.

Changing your insurance category

Whenever you apply to change your insurance, you'll be asked for details of your occupation so that your insurance category can be reviewed and updated to best match your occupation. You will be notified if your insurance category is updated.

You can also apply to have your insurance category reviewed at any time. When you do this, the insurer will assign you an insurance category based on your occupation (rather than the insurance category given to your employer, if that is the category currently assigned to you).

Your insurance category is important, because if you're in a higher risk category than your work requires, you might be paying more for your cover than you should.

If your insurance category is changed, it applies across all types of cover you may have (e.g. death, TPD, IP). We'll adjust the cost of your cover from the date the insurer approves the change.

If you apply for a change of insurance category there are three possible outcomes. The insurer may decide that:

- your existing insurance category is correct and shouldn't change
- you should have a lower risk insurance category (which would decrease the cost of your cover)
- you should have a higher risk insurance category (which would increase the cost of your cover).

Any change to your insurance category applies from the date that the insurer approves the change (that is, it is not applied retrospectively).

The easiest way to apply to change your insurance category is through Member Online.

Example

Changing your insurance category

Frank is a 30-year-old office manager who works for a mining company. His employer has a High Risk insurance category because most of the employees work with heavy machinery in a potentially hazardous environment. When Frank gets Basic Cover automatically, he gets a High Risk insurance category, so he submits a request to have his insurance category reviewed based on his occupation. After Frank confirms that he spends 90% of his time doing administrative work in the office, the insurer changes his insurance category to Low Risk. This reduces the cost of his cover.

About exclusions and loadings

Exclusions

Exclusions are medical conditions or activities that the insurer won't cover because the risk involved and cost of cover would be far too high. This is why it's important to answer truthfully when you apply for cover, because if you later claim for something the insurer would have excluded if they'd known about it, they may be entitled to refuse to pay your claim.

For example, if you're a dirt bike rider, they might not offer you additional death (including terminal illness) or TPD cover from injuries caused in a dirt bike accident. If you have diabetes, they may decide not to offer you additional death or terminal illness cover for medical conditions caused by diabetes.

If the insurer excludes any conditions or activities from your additional cover, your confirmation of cover letter will show these exclusions.

Loadings

If the insurer decides that a condition you have, or activity you take part in, has high risk, but they're still prepared to cover it, they may apply a premium loading. This is an increase in the cost of your cover that compensates the insurer for the increased chance you might make a claim.

For example, if you're an office worker during the week and an abseiling enthusiast during the weekend, the insurer might agree to give you additional death (including terminal illness) and TPD cover that does cover you for injuries received in an abseiling accident, but they might apply a 30% premium loading, increasing the cost of that additional cover by 30%.

Your confirmation of cover letter shows any exclusions and/or premium loadings that apply to your additional cover.

When does additional cover cease?

Your additional cover will cease under the same circumstances as your automatic cover (see 'When your insurance ends' on page 11).

Transferring in other cover

If you have insurance somewhere else and you'd rather have it with your Future Saver account in Aware Super, you can apply to transfer it to us.

You can apply to transfer any existing death, TPD or IP cover to your Future Saver account in Aware Super from another life insurance policy or another super fund. Your cover starts on the date the insurer accepts your transfer application, provided that you cancel your other cover (you cannot transfer cover to Aware Super then decide to keep the other cover going as well).

How much you can transfer

We'll match the level of cover you transfer in within these limits:

For this cover type...	you can transfer in up to...
Death	$10 million (only $5 million for terminal illness)
TPD	$5 million
Income Protection	$40,000 per month

Your death and TPD cover will be transferred as fixed cover amounts and added to any existing cover, subject to the above maximums, and for terminal illness and TPD cover the maximums will be reduced by your existing cover amounts. If you transfer in TPD cover, the TPD cover amount cannot be higher than your total death cover amount in the fund.

Any existing IP cover you have in the fund will be replaced with your transferred IP cover, up to the maximum amount above. If the insurer cannot match your transferred waiting period and benefit period, they will offer you the next longest waiting period and next shortest benefit period available under the fund).

Eligibility conditions

To transfer cover you must:

- be at least age 15 and under age 70 for death and TPD cover or under age 65 for IP cover
- provide satisfactory evidence of any conditions or restrictions that applied under the previous insurance policy with your application, as they will continue to apply with us
- not have been diagnosed by a medical practitioner as having a life expectancy of less than 24 months due to illness or injury
- not be entitled to receive, do not intend to receive, or have never lodged a claim for an illness or injury through workers' compensation, any superannuation fund, government benefits or any insurance policy providing total and permanent disablement, terminal illness or income protection type cover and/or accident or sickness cover
- not previously had any application for life, TPD, trauma or IP insurance declined
- be employed or self-employed when you submit your application
- have agreed not to exercise any continuation option (the ability to continue cover under a different policy with the same insurer) or reinstate cover under the previous insurance policy
- agree to cancel your cover under the other policy when we confirm that your cover has started with us
- satisfactorily answer the health, lifestyle and occupation questions in the application.

The insurer will decide whether or not to accept your transfer application. If they accept it:

- any restrictions, exclusions or loadings you have on your existing cover will continue on the transferred cover in Aware Super
- when we confirm that your cover has started you must cancel your cover under the other policy
- the insurer won't apply any restrictions if you work in a hazardous occupation, unless these restrictions already apply to the cover you're transferring.

Limited Cover Conditions may apply to transferred cover

If you are not at work on the day immediately before the day that your transferred cover starts in the fund, your cover will be subject to Limited Cover Conditions.

How to transfer cover

The simplest way to transfer your cover is by logging into Member Online and clicking on the 'Insurance' tab. The online application process includes several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle and evidence of the cover you're transferring. Based on this information, the insurer will decide whether or not to accept the transferred cover.

Cancelling your other cover

Once we've given you written confirmation that the transfer has been approved, you must cancel the other insurance policy. If you don't do this you will not be able to claim with Aware Super.



It's important that you don't cancel the other policy until **after** we've confirmed that your cover has been transferred to Aware Super.

Increasing your cover after Life Events

If you experience a life event while you are a member of the fund, such as getting married, having a child or buying a house, you can apply to increase your death, TPD or IP cover by answering a few questions within 90 days of the life event occurring, including about your employment, health and lifestyle. We call this applying for cover due to a life event.

The simplest way you can apply for cover is by logging into Member Online and clicking on the 'Insurance' tab.

Life Events include

You can apply for cover if:

- you get married, or on your first wedding anniversary with the same person; or
- you start a de facto relationship (documented), or on the first anniversary of this relationship; or
- you get divorced (or separate from a de facto relationship), or on the first anniversary of such event; or
- you or your partner gives birth to your child; or
- you adopt a child; or
- your spouse or de facto partner dies; or
- you take out a home loan to buy the property you live in, or increase the loan on your home you live in to do renovations or extensions; or
- any of your children turn 12 or start secondary school for the first time; or
- you get an increase in salary from your employer (this only applies to IP cover and isn't available if you're self-employed); or
- you reach 30, 40 and 50 years of age.

Eligibility conditions

To be eligible to apply for cover under life events you must be under age 60 at the date of the occurrence of the life event and, at the date of your application:

- have a Future Saver account balance greater than zero
- be employed or self-employed and at work
- not have increased your cover through a life event in the previous 12 months
- not have been diagnosed by a medical practitioner as having a life expectancy of less than 24 months due to illness or injury
- not previously had any application for life, TPD, trauma or IP insurance declined
- not have ever had any loadings, limitations, alternative terms or exclusions applied to any death, TPD or IP cover (including accident or sickness insurance)
- not have ever made a claim, be entitled to claim or be planning to claim for an illness or injury through workers' compensation, any superannuation fund or government benefits or any insurance policy providing total and permanent disablement, terminal illness or an income protection type cover and/or accident or sickness cover
- (if applying for increased IP cover) already be insured with us for IP cover
- satisfactorily complete the short form underwriting questions in the application.

The insurer assesses your application and decides whether to accept it; they may also apply exclusions or loadings. The increase takes effect on the date that the insurer accepts your application.

Example

Life Events cover

Kamnan is a 38-year-old chef who owns and runs his own restaurant and has $500,000 of death and TPD cover and $3,000 per month of IP cover. When he marries his fiancé Phaibun, he applies for a life event increase to his cover. He increases his death and TPD cover to $600,000 and his IP to $4,000 per month.

When Phaibun gives birth to a daughter 10 months later, Kamnan applies for another increase, but he's ineligible because he is only allowed one life event increase every 12 months. Two months later it's their first wedding anniversary, so he applies again and increases his death and TPD by another $100,000 to $700,000.

Cover limits under Life Events

Death and/or TPD

You can apply for up to $200,000 death and TPD cover for each event. The increase can be either a fixed amount or a multiple of the age-based cover scale. Total death and TPD cover cannot exceed $3 million after receiving life events cover.

Income protection

You can apply to increase your existing IP cover by up to $2,500 per month for each event, provided this does not cause your total IP cover amount to exceed $25,000 per month or 87% of your income (if lower). Your existing waiting period and benefit period don't change.

Decreasing your cover

You might consider reducing your cover if your circumstances change and you have less financial risk (e.g. you pay off your home loan, or your children leave home), or you simply want to reduce your insurance premium. Remember that if you have age-based cover such as Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover, your death and TPD cover amounts automatically start decreasing from age 41.

If you have Basic Cover, Basic Plus Cover or any other multiple of the age-based cover scale, you can reduce your cover to a new 0.5 multiple of the age-based cover scale (e.g. 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, 2.5, etc).

You can ask us to reduce your TPD cover amount to a lower value than your death cover, which reduces the cost of your cover, but your TPD cover can never be higher than your death cover.

If you have IP cover you can reduce your cover amount at any time.

Decreasing your cover amounts reduces the cost of your cover.

How to change your cover

You can cancel or decrease some or all of your cover at any time by logging into Member Online and requesting the change online. If you don't have online access, call us on **1300 650 873**.

You can cancel some parts of your cover while keeping others, however you cannot have TPD cover without, or greater than, death cover.

When you are given Basic Cover automatically, you have the option to cancel it within 60 days of us activating your cover. If you do this we refund any premiums you've paid. This means that your cover never started, so you can't make a claim for any event that happened during the period before you cancelled your cover. In all other circumstances, if you cancel your cover it ends on the date we get your cancellation request. We send you a notice confirming the date your cover ended. You can't make any claims for events that happen on or after this date.

If you're thinking about cancelling your insurance, bear in mind that you may not be able to get the same cover again in the future.

Applying for cover after cancelling or decreasing your cover

If you choose to cancel or decrease your cover, you can apply for new cover at any time. The insurer will ask you several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle, and on the basis of your answers the insurer will decide whether or not to accept your application, or apply exclusions or loadings.

Opting out of receiving cover automatically

Opting out is different from cancelling. You can cancel Basic Cover you got automatically even if you've only held it for one day, whereas opting out means telling us you don't want to receive Basic Cover automatically, *before* you get it.

If you opt out of automatically receiving Basic Cover, we won't offer it to you again under your existing Future Saver account. This means you will not be able to apply for Basic Cover or Basic Plus Cover in the future. If you decide later that you would like insurance, you will have to apply for underwritten cover and the insurer will decide whether or not to offer you cover.

The questions asked when you apply for insurance

When you apply for life insurance you're treated as if you're applying under an individual consumer insurance contract. The insurer will ask you several questions, including some about your employment, health and lifestyle, medical history, pastimes and current and past insurance (this is called 'underwriting'). It's how the insurer decides whether they can cover you, and if so, on what terms and at what cost.

The information you provide in response to those questions will be vital to the insurer's decision.

Your duty to take reasonable care

When answering these questions, you have a legal duty to take reasonable care not to make a misrepresentation to the insurer. A misrepresentation is a false answer, an answer that is only partially true, or an answer which does not fairly reflect the truth.

This duty also applies when extending or making changes to existing insurance, and reinstating insurance.

If you don't meet your legal duty, this can have serious impacts on your insurance. The insurer can avoid your cover (treat it as if it never existed) or change its terms. This could also mean they decline a claim or reduce a benefit payment.

Whether the insurer can do this depends on a number of factors, including:

- whether you took reasonable care not to make a misrepresentation
- what the insurer would have done if you'd met your duty (for example, whether they would have still offered you cover and on what terms)
- whether the misrepresentation was fraudulent
- in some cases, how long it has been since the cover started.

If the insurer decides to do any of these things they will explain the reasons for their decision, how to respond and what you can do if you disagree.

Making a claim

An insurance payment can help during tough times. If you or your beneficiaries must make a claim, we're here to support you and we aim to make the claims process as simple as possible.

Death claims

In the unfortunate circumstance of your death, your beneficiary or legal representative can make a claim for your death benefit and superannuation account balance.

For more information about beneficiaries and how to nominate beneficiaries, see our *Super Handbook* on our website.

What we pay

The payment is the total of the deceased person's:

- death cover, based on the sum insured on the date they died; plus their
- Future Saver account balance, less any unpaid insurance premiums, taxes and fees.

If there's more than one beneficiary, each beneficiary may get different parts of this total.

How to claim

Your beneficiary or beneficiaries can notify us using our online notification system at **aware.com.au** or by calling us on **1300 650 873**.

We recommend they first download the *How to claim a death benefit* factsheet available on our website.

This factsheet explains the claim process and the information they'll need to provide.

Terminal illness claims

For the purposes of your cover, terminal illness means that two medical practitioners (one a specialist in the area of your Illness or Injury) have certified that as a result of your Illness or Injury you're unlikely to live more than 24 months.

What we pay

If your terminal illness claim is accepted, the death cover amount on your date of terminal illness (maximum $5 million applies, even if you have higher death cover) is paid into your Future Saver account, then it is up to you whether you want to withdraw some or all of it, including any of your Future Saver account balance. There is no requirement to withdraw any of the terminal illness benefit, you can leave it all in your Future Saver account until you wish to withdraw some or all of it. You may wish to get financial advice.

How to claim

You can download a terminal illness claim pack from our website or by calling us on **1300 650 873**. We recommend you first download the *How to claim a terminal illness benefit* factsheet available on our website.

This factsheet explains the claim process and the information you'll need to provide.

TPD and IP claims

When you make a TPD or IP claim, the insurer will assess your claim to determine whether you're disabled and to what extent. This can be a complex process involving consultations with medical specialists and attending rehabilitation programs and can take a long time.

The sooner you tell us about your illness or injury the better, because any delay can complicate things and make it harder for the insurer to assess your claim.

What is paid

If your TPD claim is accepted, the TPD cover amount is paid into your Future Saver account, then it is up to you whether you want to withdraw some or all of it, including any of your Future Saver account balance. There is no requirement to withdraw any of the TPD benefit, you can leave it all in your Future Saver account until you wish to withdraw some or all of it.

If you have IP cover when your TPD claim is approved by the insurer, your IP cover ceases effective from that date (see 'Stopping your IP cover when a TPD claim is approved' on page 12).

Your IP benefit may not be your full IP cover. It may be less if your IP cover is greater than 87% of your pre-disability income, or if offsets apply. It will also be impacted by whether you are considered to be totally disabled or partially disabled. If your IP claim is accepted, the income component is paid directly to you by the insurer and the superannuation component (if any) is paid into your Future Saver account.

If you're unsure what to do with your benefit you can speak with one of our advisers (fees may apply, for more information on our advice options go to **aware.com.au/adviceoptions**).

How to claim

You can claim online or over the phone, but first we recommend you download the factsheets on *How to claim a permanent disability benefit* and *How to claim an income protection benefit* available on our website

These factsheets explain the claim process and the information you'll need to provide. If you have any questions, call us on **1300 650 873**.

To claim online

To claim online, log into Member Online, and select *Make a Claim*. We'll ask you to confirm:

- the type of claim you're making
- the date of your last day at work
- whether or not your doctor has certified you unfit for work.

We may ask you to complete some more details online or we may call you.

To claim over the phone

To claim over the phone, gather these details then call us:

- your member number
- the date you last worked before your illness or injury
- the name of your last employer
- a description of your illness or injury.

Once we have all the information, we pass your claim to the insurer.

Premium refunds for approved claims

When a death or TPD claim is approved, any premiums (in respect of the amount of the approved claim) that have been deducted from your Future Saver account after the effective date of the claim will be refunded to your account. For premium refund purposes only, the effective date of the claim is:

- death claims: the date of death
- TPD claims: the later of 1 April 2020 or the date of disablement (see page 42).

When an IP claim is approved, the insurer waives your IP premiums for the period from the end of the waiting period to the date that your IP benefits cease. Any premiums already deducted from your Future Saver account in respect of this period will be refunded to your account.

Premiums that are already waived by a Severe Financial Hardship or Parental Leave insurance premium waiver will not be subject to any further refund in the event of a successful claim.

For more information on the Severe Financial Hardship or Parental Leave insurance premium waiver, including the terms and the eligibility requirements, see page 22.

Our role in the claims process

When you make a claim, we pass your information to the insurer so they can assess your claim.

As trustee of the fund, we're required to take reasonable steps to safeguard the interests of all our members. If we disagree with the insurer's decision about your claim, we'll ask them to review their decision and we may ask you for more information.

How we invest your benefit

If you die, your Future Saver account balance will be moved to the Cash investment option when we are notified of your death.

If the insurer approves a death, terminal illness or TPD claim, the insurance payment is paid into your Future Saver account and invested in the Cash investment option.

For terminal illness and TPD benefit claims, your pre-existing account balance stays invested in your existing investment option(s). You can switch your insurance payment out of the Cash option into other investment options at any time.

Tax on benefit payments

When you get an insurance benefit, the Australian Taxation Office (ATO) may tax it, depending on the type of benefit and who gets the benefit.

Death and TPD benefits

We deduct any applicable tax from death and TPD benefits before we pay them.

To enable us to pay a benefit to you:

- the insurer must pay your claim; and
- the trustee must be satisfied that you meet a condition of release under superannuation law.

The conditions of release under superannuation law are described in our *Super Handbook* which is available on our website or by contacting us.

The tax treatment of lump sum death and TPD payments depends on your (or your beneficiaries) circumstances, and the tax rules can change frequently, so please see our *Super Handbook* at **aware.com.au/pds** or ask one of our financial advisers for advice.

You can also go to the ATO website at **ato.gov.au**

Income protection payments

IP payments are taxed as income.



Other things you need to know

Complaints resolution

We can usually answer any questions you have about your account over the phone. If you're not satisfied with the response or need more help, please contact our Complaints Team:

Email:	complaints_officer@aware.com.au
Online:	**aware.com.au/contact**
Phone:	1300 650 873
International:	+61 3 9131 6373
In writing:	Aware Super Complaints Officer GPO Box 89 Melbourne VIC 3001

Once we receive your complaint, we will investigate and try to resolve your concerns as soon as possible, generally within 30 days.

If you're not satisfied with the outcome, you can contact the Australian Financial Complaints Authority (AFCA). AFCA provides free and independent service to help resolve complaints and can be contacted as follow:

Online:	**afca.org.au**
Email:	info@afca.org.au
Phone:	1800 931 678 (free call)
In writing:	Australian Financial Complaints Authority, GPO Box 3, Melbourne VIC 3001

How we protect your privacy

Our privacy information (sensitive information)

This privacy information outlines how sensitive member information is collected, used and disclosed by us. Sensitive information (such as health or medical information) about fund members is always handled with extreme care and diligence.

This information includes two parts: a **Collection Notice** and a **Privacy Policy Statement**. The Collection Notice explains why we collect sensitive information and outlines possible consequences if this information is not provided to us. It also lists organisations to which we may disclose sensitive member information.

The Privacy Policy Statement explains how we are obligated to handle sensitive information and how further information about privacy can be obtained. If you would like to request access to your sensitive information held by us, you can contact us on **1300 650 873**. We reserve the right to postpone access while a claim is under consideration.

Collection notice

We are required to obtain members' consent before we collect any sensitive information (such as health or medical information) from members.

So that your consent will be informed, we advise the following:

- Aware Super Pty Ltd ABN 11 118 202 672 AFSL 293340 is the trustee of Aware Super ABN 53 226 460 365.
- You can gain access to your sensitive information held by us by contacting us on the above number. We reserve the right to postpone access while a claim is under consideration.

We collect sensitive information about you primarily to:

- assess eligibility for and arrange insurance
- assess entitlement to pay a death benefit to which your beneficiary/s or your estate may become entitled
- assess entitlement to pay a disability benefit (including any insured component) to which you may become entitled
- provide appropriate information and advice about insurance features that may be relevant to you.
- in respect of the purposes listed, the types of organisations to which we usually disclose sensitive information include:
  - the fund's insurer and underwriter
  - regulators and other Commonwealth Government agencies, such as the Australian Financial Complaints Authority (AFCA)
  - professional advisers
  - medical practitioners and medico-legal consultants
  - other product providers who administer products on behalf of us
  - service providers including, but not limited to, internationally-based providers of internet, data storage and data access services and systems which may be located in countries including Germany, the United Kingdom, United States, Canada and New Zealand.

We are required to collect information to meet our obligations under relevant law, including the *Superannuation Industry (Supervision) Act 1993* and Regulations. The main consequences of you not providing all or part of your sensitive information to us are:

- our insurer may be unable to assess your eligibility for insurance
- we and/or our insurer may be unable to assess whether you (or your beneficiary/s or estate) are entitled to a death or disability benefit (including any insured benefit)
- processing of your death or disability claim may be delayed
- our insurer may be unable to pay you any insured benefit to which you, your beneficiary/s or your estate may become entitled
- we may be unable to correctly calculate any death benefit to which your beneficiary/s or your estate may become entitled
- we may be unable to distribute a death benefit or pay a disability benefit to you.

Privacy Policy Statement

We are subject to the Australian Privacy Principles of the *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth). We collect and hold personal information relating to members. The member information we hold is used for administration purposes, the provision of financial planning advice and for promotional activities.

In some cases, Aware Super engages third parties to host electronic data (including data in relation to the services we provide) on our behalf. These data warehouses may be located overseas in countries including Germany, the United Kingdom, United States, Canada and New Zealand and must have in place appropriate security and privacy protocols.

If we do not have all your necessary personal information, we may not be able to process an application from you or you may not receive certain benefits that you are entitled to as a member.

We take security measures to protect the personal information we hold. Your information is only accessible by fund personnel and authorised service providers of the trustee, including the insurer. The trustee may provide your personal information to an overseas fund, such as a KiwiSaver scheme in New Zealand, with your consent. Access to your details is protected, however your spouse/de facto may be entitled to obtain information about your super in certain circumstances (i.e. family law matters).

Our privacy policy contains information about how you may access and seek correction of your personal information, how you may complain about a breach of your privacy and other important information about how your personal information is collected, used and disclosed. For further information about how your personal information is handled, please phone us on **1300 650 873** or visit **aware.com.au/privacy** to view our privacy policy. A paper copy of the policy can be provided free of charge on request.

Your privacy with TAL Life Limited, ABN 70 050 109 450, AFSL 237848

TAL is bound by current Australian Privacy Legislation including the *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth) and the 13 Australian Privacy Principles. Their information handling practices are explained in the TAL Privacy Policy which explains who they are and why they need to collect information when providing the products and services. It also describes how TAL stores information, how you can obtain access to information they hold about you and how you can update or correct information if required. In providing their products and services, TAL may disclose personal information to some third parties and the TAL Privacy Policy provides details about this disclosure. In all circumstances, third parties are required to keep personal information confidential and only use the information for the purposes of assisting TAL provide our products and services. TAL's Privacy Policy can be viewed on its website at **tal.com.au/privacy-policy**.

What the words mean

Term	Meaning
Accident	Means an unforeseen violent, external and visible event that occurs accidentally during the period of cover.
Approved Rehabilitation Program	Means a program, device or course of treatment approved by the insurer and agreed (as required) between you, the insurer, a Medical Practitioner and an employer (where authorised by you), that will assist your rehabilitation and return to Gainful Employment.
At work	A person is considered to be 'at work' on a day if the person was not receiving or claiming and/or entitled to claim income support benefits from any source in respect of that day, including but not limited to, workers' compensation benefits, statutory transport accident benefits and disability income benefits, and the person was: (a) in paid employment on that day, and either: (i) performing all of their normal and usual duties of paid employment without restriction, or (ii) would have been capable of performing all of their normal and usual duties of paid employment without restriction had the day not been: – a public holiday, or – a weekend day, or – a day on which the person was on employer approved leave that wasn't related to the person's Illness or Injury; or (b) not in paid employment on that day and was not restricted by Illness or Injury from otherwise being able to carry out the duties of their usual occupation for at least 35 hours per week. A person who does not meet this definition is correspondingly described as being 'not At Work'.
Australian Resident	Means a person who is legally permitted to reside and work for reward in Australia.
Benefit Period	Means the maximum period for which the insurer will pay a benefit for a claim in relation to the same or related Illness or Injury. The benefit period is that nominated by you and accepted by the insurer.
Certification Period	Means in respect of Terminal Illness cover, means a period of not more than 24 months, which commences from the date a Medical Practitioner certifies in writing that you are Terminally Ill.
CPI	Means the Consumer Price Index (all groups weighted average for eight capital cities) issued by the Australian Bureau of Statistics for the 12 months to the end of the most recently completed quarter before the date of calculation.
Date of Disablement (for income protection cover)	Means the first date that you were totally unable to work in your Own Occupation due to the Illness or Injury that is the subject of your claim for benefits. In the case of a member who ceases to be Disabled (whether before or after their Waiting Period has been satisfied), the Date of Disablement will mean the next earliest date that they are totally unable to work in their Own Occupation due to Illness or Injury. The Date of Disablement must always be certified by a Medical Practitioner.
Date of Disablement (for TPD cover)	In respect of Total and Permanent Disablement cover, means: (a) where you were engaged in Gainful Employment - the date you cease all work-related duties due to Illness or Injury; or (b) where you were not engaged in Gainful Employment – the date you cease to be able to engage in Gainful Employment due to Illness or Injury, as certified by a Medical Practitioner. For the purposes of paragraph (a), up to two unsuccessful attempts by you to return to Gainful Employment for less than 30 consecutive days each attempt will be disregarded.
Date of Terminal Illness	In respect of Terminal Illness cover, means the earlier of the dates on which two Medical Practitioners have certified in writing that you are Terminally Ill, regardless of whether cover is in force on the date of the second certification.
Disability/Disabled (for income protection cover)	Means either Total Disability or Partial Disability.
Election	Means a written election provided to the Fund that is made by you in accordance with the *Superannuation Industry (Supervision) Act 1993* (Cth) to take out or maintain insurance.
Eligibility Date (called *PMIF Eligibility Date* in the policy)	Means the date all of the following first apply to you: (a) you are an employer sponsored member; (b) you are at least 25 years of age; and (c) your current Future Saver Account has reached a balance of at least $6,000 (on or after 1 May 2023, or the date you most recently joined the Fund, if later).

Term	Meaning
Employed/ Employment	Means being employed for remuneration or reward.
Employment Commencement Date	Means, for an Eligible Person who is a Dangerous Occupation Member, the later of: (a) the date the person commenced employment with their Dangerous Occupation Participating Employer as notified by the Dangerous Occupation Participating Employer via a 'member registration request', otherwise (b) the start date of the contribution period (reported on the 'contributions transactions request' file) of the first SG contribution for that member from that Dangerous Occupation Participating Employer.
Gainful Employment /Gainfully Employed	Means performance or work for actual or expected remuneration, reward or other economic benefit to you or a person or entity connected with you. Gainful Employment includes being Employed or Self-Employed.
Illness	Means sickness, disease or disorder.
Important Duties	One or more duties which are important and essential in producing income.
Inactive	Means the Fund has not received a contribution or rollover in respect of your account.
Injury	Means bodily injury which is caused solely and directly by external, violent and accidental means and is independent of any other cause.
Leave without pay (LWOP)	Means a period of leave taken by you during which you earn no income from an employer. It does not include any period of part time leave without pay where you are working for that employer in any capacity.
Life Events	Means one of the following events that occurs to you for which the insurer may provide cover to you: (a) your marriage or documented commencement of a de facto relationship; (b) your divorce (including separation from de facto partner; (c) the first anniversary of the events in (a) or (b) above with the same person; (d) birth of your child; (e) adoption of a child by you; (f) the death of your spouse or de facto partner; (g) you taking out a new mortgage to purchase your primary residence, or increasing an existing mortgage to renovate or extend your primary residence; (h) your child turns 12 years of age or commences secondary school for the first time; or (i) (for IP only) your increase in salary when employed by an employer; or (j) you reach 30, 40 and 50 years of age.
Limited Cover Conditions	Means cover is restricted to claims arising from an Illness or Injury that first becomes **Apparent** on or after the date that the cover started or, if the cover recommenced or was reinstated, on or after the date that the cover recommenced or was reinstated. **Apparent** means that you were aware of, or a reasonable person in the circumstances could be expected to have been aware of, the Illness or Injury.
Maximum Cover Limit	Means the maximum amount of cover available for you under the policy as follows: • death cover: Unlimited • Terminal Illness cover: $5,000,000 • Total and Permanent Disablement cover: $5,000,000 • income protection cover: $40,000 per month
Medical Care	Means you are receiving and following treatment or advice recommended by a Medical Practitioner who has personally assessed you and has been provided with full clinical details of your case, and you will continue to be reviewed in these circumstances on at least a monthly basis unless otherwise agreed by the insurer.
Medical Practitioner	Means, unless the insurer agrees otherwise, a medical practitioner legally qualified and registered to practice in Australia, but shall not include chiropractors, physiotherapists, psychologists and alternative health providers. The Medical Practitioner cannot be: (a) you; (b) your spouse or partner in a de facto relationship, parent, child, sibling or close family relative; (c) your business partner, associate, employer or employee; or (d) a fellow shareholder or unit holder of you in a company or trust that is not a publicly listed company or trust.

Term	Meaning
Monthly Income	Means your gross monthly income earned from personal exertion from your main occupation, or occupations, averaged over the 12 months immediately prior to applying for income protection cover, aside from bonuses which are to be averaged over the 3 years prior to applying for income protection cover. If you have been Employed or Self-employed for less than 12 months before applying for income protection cover, your gross monthly income will be averaged over the period since you last started Employment or Self-employment. **Note:** For the purpose of calculating your Monthly Income: (a) Superannuation Guarantee contributions are not included; and (b) if you are Self-employed, your share of business expenses are to be deducted.
Other Disability Income	Means, subject to paragraph (d) and (e) of this definition, any amount which you receive, or are entitled to receive, in connection with, or arising out of, the Injury or Illness causing your Total Disability or Partial Disability, which you may receive or be entitled to receive during a month a Benefit is payable (whereby lump sum, periodic payment or otherwise) whether that amount was actually received or not, including: (a) any amount paid or payable, including any superannuation components: (i) under another income protection insurance policy, salary continuance insurance policy, loan protection insurance policy, or similar policy, in any jurisdiction; (ii) under any workers' compensation, motor accident compensation, statutory compensation or similar scheme, however named, in any jurisdiction or other similar state, federal, territory or ex-traterritorial legislation; (iii) under common law or under state, federal, territory or extraterritorial legislation unless excluded under (d) or (e) below; (iv) as employer-funded sick leave (paid amount only), personal leave or any other employer-paid leave in any jurisdiction; (b) any out of court settlement sum, or any award of money sum by a court, tribunal, arbitrator or government body in any jurisdiction; (c) whether an amount under paragraph (a) of this definition is: (i) a lump sum, a periodic payment, a combination of a lump sum and a periodic payment, or otherwise; or (ii) in the nature of a capital payment or income payment (as those terms are understood having regard to normal accounting standard and practice), has no bearing on whether that amount is Other Disability Income or otherwise; (d) note that Other Disability Income does not include: (i) an amount paid or payable under this Policy or Return to Employment Income; (ii) Centrelink, Department of Veterans Affairs, or any equivalent or replacement agencies benefits; (iii) any amount paid under an insurance policy providing total and permanent disablement benefits or a terminal illness or critical illness benefits; (iv) annual leave or long service leave; or (v) a pension or annuity paid from a superannuation fund other than a disability pension, whether a lump sum, a periodic payment, a combination of a lump sum and a periodic payment, or otherwise; (e) in addition to the amounts, benefits and payments excluded under paragraph (d), We will not consider any portion of an amount paid or payable to you to be Other Disability Income, if you establish to the insurers reasonable satisfaction, that it represents or covers compensation for or payment in respect of: (i) pain and suffering; (ii) the loss of a part, or the use of a part of the body to the extent that such compensation is not income or capital (as those terms are understood having regard to normal accounting standards and practice); (iii) medical expenses; or (iv) reasonable legal expenses, and, for clarity, to the extent that you cannot establish to the Insurers satisfaction, acting reasonably, that any portion of an amount paid or payable to you represents compensation for or payment in respect of those items set out in (i) to (iv) above, the entirety of that amount will be deemed to be Other Disability Income; and (f) where Other Disability Income is in the form of a lump sum or is commuted to a lump sum, the monthly Benefit will be reduced by an amount equal to one sixtieth (1/60) of the lump sum over a period of sixty months or the remainder of the Benefit Period, whichever is the less.
Own Occupation	Means the occupation or regular duties in which you have spent the most amount of the time engaged in during the 12 months prior to the Date of Disablement. In the event that you suffer an Illness or Injury while on employer approved Leave Without Pay, or Parental Leave, the occupation you performed before commencing the leave will be the occupation used for the purposes of determining Total Disability.

Term	Meaning
Parental Leave	Means a continuous period of leave, whether paid or unpaid, that is taken in connection with the birth of a child or adoption of a child, that is approved by the employer. This includes maternity leave or paternity leave.
Partial Monthly Benefit	Means the lesser of: (a) your insured monthly IP benefit; and (b) 87% of your Pre-disability Income
Partially Disabled/ Partial Disability	Means that in the insurer's opinion you are no longer Totally Disabled and, solely as a result of an Illness or Injury that caused you to be Totally Disabled, you: (a) do not have the capacity to work in your Own Occupation at the same level that you were working at prior to commencement of Total Disability; and (b) are earning Return to Employment Income that is less than your Pre-disability Income; and (c) are under Medical Care.
Participating Employer	Means an employer participating in the Fund in accordance with the Trust Deed.
Police Officer	Means a member of the NSW Police Force holding a position which is designated under the *Police Act 1990* as a position to be held by a police officer.
Premium Waiver Period	Means the period of no more than 12 continuous months in which premiums payable under the policy are waived, in connection with a Parental Leave insurance premium waiver or a Severe Financial Hardship insurance premium waiver.
Pre-disability Income	Your gross monthly income earned from personal exertion from your main occupation, or occupations, averaged over the 12 months immediately prior to your Date of Disablement (aside from bonuses which are to be averaged over the 3 years prior to your Date of Disablement). If you have been Employed or Self-employed for less than 12 months before your Date of Disablement, your gross monthly income will be averaged over the period since you last started Employment or Self-employment. **Note:** For the purpose of calculating your Pre-disability Income: (a) Superannuation Guarantee contributions are not included; and (b) if you are Self-employed, your share of business expenses are to be deducted; and (c) if you are on employer approved Leave Without Pay, or Parental Leave, special provisions apply (refer to the relevant policy).
Return to Employment Income (for income protection purposes)	Means the gross income received by you during the month in respect of which a Partial Disability benefit is payable, and which is earned as a consequence of your personal exertion (including commissions, bonus, leave payments and other payments that the insurer reasonably considers form part of your remuneration package). **Note:** For the purpose of calculating your Return to Employment Income: (a) Superannuation Guarantee contributions are not included; and (b) if you are Self-employed, your share of business expenses is to be deducted.
Self-employed or Self-employment	Means you are performing activities for remuneration or reward in a business of which you directly or indirectly own all or part.
Severe Financial Hardship	Means 'severe financial hardship' as provided for under the associated condition of release in the *Superannuation Industry (Supervision) Act 1993* (Cth).
Specialist Medical Practitioner	Means a person who is a Medical Practitioner and: (a) who, if the claimed illness is a mental health condition, is a Medical Practitioner legally qualified as a practicing psychiatrist and registered with the Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency (AHPRA) (and the insurer requires the condition to have been diagnosed by the Specialist Medical Practitioner in accordance with the latest edition of the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders); otherwise (b) who is a Medical Practitioner who is a specialist as determined by the relevant medical registration boards and registered with the Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency (AHPRA); and is currently practicing in a specialist area related to the Illness or Injury that the claim is for.

Term	Meaning
Specific Medical Condition	Means one of the following medical conditions, certified by a Medical Practitioner or health professional whose educational qualifications and area of speciality are appropriate for your Illness or Injury: (a) Blindness; (b) Cardiomyopathy; (c) Chronic Lung Disease; (d) Dementia and Alzheimer's Disease; (e) Idiopathic Pulmonary Arterial Hypertension; (f) Loss of Hearing / Deafness; (g) Loss of Speech; (h) Major Head Trauma; (i) Motor Neurone Disease; (j) Multiple Sclerosis; (k) Muscular Dystrophy; (l) Paralysis; (m) Parkinson's Disease.
Student Police Officer	Means a person who: (a) is enrolled into the Associate Degree in Policing Practice (ADPP); and (b) is employed by the NSW Police Force.
Sum Insured	Means your total amount of cover, whether provided automatically or by application, or a combination of such cover, and whether for an amount in accordance with an Age-Based Cover Scale or a fixed-dollar amount or a combination of such amounts, determined in accordance with the terms of the Policy.
Terminal Illness/ Terminally Ill	Means: (a) two Medical Practitioners have jointly or separately certified in writing that you are suffering from an Illness, or have incurred an Injury, that is likely to result in your death within the Certification Period; (b) at least one of the Medical Practitioners is a specialist practising in an area related to the Illness or Injury suffered by you; (c) at least one of the certifications referred to in clause (a) occurs while your death cover is in force; (d) for each of the certifications, the Certification Period has not ended; and (e) We are satisfied, on medical or other evidence, that despite reasonable medical treatment, the Illness or Injury will lead to your death within the Certification Period.
Terrorism	Means the use of force or violence (or threats of force or violence) performed in connection with political, religious, ideological or similar purposes.
Total and Permanent Disablement/ Totally and Permanently Disabled	Means, in the insurer's opinion, (a), (b), (c) and (d) below are satisfied: (a) if you: (i) are engaged in Gainful Employment immediately prior to your Date of Disablement – you have ceased all work-related duties due to Illness or Injury, as certified by a Medical Practitioner; (ii) are not engaged in Gainful Employment immediately prior to your Date of Disablement – you have ceased to be able to engage in any Gainful Employment due to Illness or Injury, as certified by a Medical Practitioner; (b) where the occurrence of (a) above: (i) is due to a Specific Medical Condition - you have been continuously unable to engage in any Gainful Employment from your Date of Disablement until the date the insurer forms their opinion; (ii) is not due to a Specific Medical Condition - you have been unable to engage in any Gainful Employment for a continuous period of 3 months immediately following your Date of Disablement and continuously since, until the date the insurer forms their opinion; (c) as at the date the insurer forms their opinion, you: (i) are under the care of a health professional whose educational qualifications and specialty are appropriate for your Illness or Injury, at a frequency that is appropriate for your medical condition, and you are complying with all reasonable advice and treatment given by that health professional; and (ii) have exhausted all reasonable and appropriate medical treatment options, including rehabilitation and interventions for your Illness or Injury; and

Term	Meaning
Total and Permanent Disablement/ Totally and Permanently Disabled (continued)	(d) due to Illness or Injury you are unlikely ever to engage in any Gainful Employment for which you are reasonably qualified by education, training or experience. For the purposes of paragraph (b), up to two unsuccessful attempts by you to return to Gainful Employment for less than 30 consecutive days each attempt will not preclude you from satisfying paragraph (b). In forming their opinion as to whether you are Totally and Permanently Disabled, the insurer will have regard to factors including but not limited to: • any evidence that they consider is reasonably necessary to form their opinion and is reasonably available to them up until the date they form their opinion; • medical advice, the advice of a Specialist Medical Practitioner appointed by the insurer, the advice of other experts (medical or otherwise) and any other information that the insurer considers to be appropriate and relevant at the date when they form their opinion; • any retraining, work, voluntary work or rehabilitation that you could reasonably undertake or have already undertaken, as well as any further reasonable treatments (medical or otherwise) or medication reasonably available that could enable you to return to work in the future; • your capacity to work, and without limiting the concept of work to work that is available in your local area.
Totally Disabled/ Total Disability (for income protection purposes)	Means that in the insurer's opinion, you are, because of Illness or Injury: (a) under Medical Care; (b) not working in any occupation (whether paid or unpaid); (c) during the first 2 years of the Benefit Period, not capable of doing the Important Duties of your Own Occupation; and (d) after the first 2 years of the Benefit Period, because of the same Illness or Injury, you are not capable of performing any occupation (whether paid or unpaid) for which you are reasonably suited by education, training or experience.
Waiting Period	Means the continuous period, commencing from your Date of Disablement, for which you have to be continuously Disabled before a benefit is payable. If, during the Waiting Period, you return to Gainful Employment and therefore cease to be either Partially Disabled or Totally Disabled, your Waiting Period will be extended or restarted as follows: (a) if you returned to Gainful Employment for five days or less and you again become Disabled as a result of the same Illness or Injury, the Waiting Period will be regarded as continuous but it will be extended by the number of days for which you were in Gainful Employment; (b) if you returned to Gainful Employment for more than five days and you again become Disabled (whether as a result of the same or a different Illness or Injury), a new Waiting Period will commence; (c) notwithstanding (a) and (b) above, where you have returned to Gainful Employment as part of an Approved Rehabilitation Program and you again become Disabled as a result of the same Illness or Injury within your Waiting Period, the Waiting Period will be regarded as continuous and any days of Gainful Employment will not be added to the Waiting Period. In other cases, a new Waiting Period will recommence.
War	Means inclusive of all war and not limited to declared or undeclared war or war related activities, revolution, invasion or rebellion or civil unrest. War does not include Terrorism.

Specific medical conditions defined

Medical condition	Meaning
Blindness	Means the permanent and irrecoverable loss of sight (whether aided or unaided) in both eyes, as a result of Illness or Injury to the extent that visual acuity in both eyes, on a Snellen Scale after correction by suitable lens is less than 6/60 or to the extent that the visual field is reduced to 20 degrees or less of arc.
Cardiomyopathy	Means a disease of the heart muscle characterised by structural, functional and/or electrophysiological dysfunction of the heart muscle resulting in significant permanent and irreversible cardiac impairment, to the degree of at least Class III on the New York Heart Association classification of cardiac impairment.
Chronic Lung Failure (requiring permanent oxygen therapy)	Means end stage lung disease with a consistent pulmonary function test result of: • FEV1 less than 40% predicted; or • a DLCO less than 40% predicted; • and you are on permanent oxygen therapy.
Dementia and Alzheimer's Disease	Means the unequivocal diagnosis of dementia by a consultant neurologist, or geriatrician. The diagnosis must confirm dementia or Alzheimer's Disease due to permanent failure of brain function with associated cognitive impairment. A Mini-Mental State Examination score of 24 or less out of 30; or evidence from another neuropsychometric test that is acceptable to the insurer is required.
Idiopathic pulmonary arterial hypertension (of specified severity)	Means idiopathic pulmonary arterial hypertension with substantial right ventricular enlargement established by investigations including cardiac catheterisation, resulting in physical permanent impairment to the degree of at least Class III of New York Heart Association classification of cardiac impairment. The condition must be diagnosed by an appropriate Specialist Medical Practitioner.
Loss of Hearing/ Deafness (permanent)	Means the irrecoverable profound loss of all hearing in both ears, resulting in an auditory threshold of 91 decibels or greater, averaged at frequencies 500, 1000 and 3000 hertz, both natural and assisted, as a result of Illness or Injury. The condition must be diagnosed by an appropriate Specialist Medical Practitioner.
Loss of Speech (permanent)	Means the total and irrecoverable loss of the ability to produce intelligible speech, as a result of permanent damage to the larynx or its nerve supply or to the speech centres of the brain, due to Illness or Injury.
Major Head Trauma (with permanent neurological deficit)	Means accidental head injury resulting in neurological deficit causing: • permanent Whole Person Impairment of at least 25%; or • you are totally and permanently unable to perform any one of the 'Everyday Working Activities'. Whole Person Impairment means where a payment depends on you meeting criteria based on the Whole Person Impairment, the calculation is to be based on the latest edition of the American Medical Association publication titled 'Guides to the Evaluation of Permanent Impairment' until an equivalent Australian guide, sanctioned by the Australian Medical Association, has been produced, at which time the calculation in the relevant Australian guide will apply. 'Everyday Working Activities' means the following five activities: (a) Mobility: the ability to: (i) bend, kneel or squat to pick something up from the floor and straighten up again, and the ability to get into and out of a standard sedan car, and the ability to sit in a chair for prolonged periods; or (ii) walk more than 200 metres on a level surface without stopping due to breathlessness or severe discomfort. (b) Communication: the ability to speak in your first language with sufficient clarity such that they can hold a conversation in a quiet room by understanding a simple message and relaying that message to another person. (c) Vision: the ability to read ordinary newsprint and pass the standard eye test for a car licence (with glasses or contact lenses if needed) and your vision is better than legal blindness. Legal blindness is as certified by an ophthalmologist. (d) Lifting: the ability to lift (from floor to waist), carry and move an object weighing 10 kg with hands, including using both hands together. (e) Manual dexterity: the ability, with reasonable precision and success, to use at least one hand, including thumbs and fingers, to manipulate small objects (such as picking up a coin, fastening shoelaces or buttons, using cutlery or using a pen or keyboard to write a short note).

Medical condition	Meaning
Motor Neurone Disease (progressive and debilitating)	Means the unequivocal diagnosis of a progressive form of debilitating Motor Neurone Disease by an appropriate Specialist Medical Practitioner. The diagnosis must be supported by ancillary testing (e.g. clinical neurophysiology) and exclusion of other causes by imaging and appropriate investigations.
Multiple Sclerosis (with multiple episodes of neurological deficit and persisting neurological abnormalities)	Means a disease characterised by demyelination in the brain and/or spinal cord. Multiple Sclerosis must be unequivocally diagnosed by an appropriate Specialist Medical Practitioner. There must be more than one episode of well-defined neurological deficit with persisting neurological abnormalities. Neurological investigations such as lumbar puncture, MRI (Magnetic Resonance Imaging) evidence of lesions in the central nervous system, evoked visual responses, and evoked auditory responses are required to confirm diagnosis.
Muscular Dystrophy	Means the unequivocal diagnosis of muscular dystrophy by an appropriate Specialist Medical Practitioner. The diagnosis must be supported by appropriate clinical investigations including genetic test, muscle biopsy or electromyography.
Paralysis	Means the total and permanent loss of function of two or more limbs through Illness or Injury causing permanent damage to the nervous system. This includes, but is not limited to quadriplegia, paraplegia, diplegia and hemiplegia.
Parkinson's Disease (permanent)	Means the unequivocal diagnosis of degenerative idiopathic Parkinson's disease by an appropriate Specialist Medical Practitioner, caused by degeneration of the nigrostriatal system and as characterised by the clinical manifestation of one or more of the following: • rigidity; • tremor; and • akinesia. All other types of Parkinsonism are excluded (e.g. secondary to medication).

Questions? We've got answers.

Contact us:

1300 650 873

aware.com.au/contact

GPO Box 89, Melbourne VIC 3001

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